

MENON ΜΕΝΩΝ

(OR CONCERNING **VIRTUE/EXCELLENCE** : VALIDATIVE)
(Η ΠΕΡΙ ΑΡΕΤΗΣ : ΠΕΙΡΑΣΤΙΚΟΣ)

THE PERSONS OF THE DIALOGUE :
ΤΑ ΠΡΟΣΩΠΑ ΤΟΥ ΔΙΑΛΟΓΟΥ

MENON , SOCRATES , MENON'S SLAVE-BOY, ANYTOS
ΜΕΝΩΝ , ΣΩΚΡΑΤΗΣ , ΜΕΝΩΝΟΣ ΠΑΙΣ , ΑΝΥΤΟΣ

Menon: Can you tell me , O Socrates , whether virtue is teachable ? Or is virtue not teachable ,

70A Έχεις ειπείν μοι , ω Σωκράτες , αρα η αρετη διδακτον ; η ου διδακτον
but acquired by practice ? Or if neither by practice nor by learning , then does it come to human beings
αλλ' ασκητον ; η ουτε ασκητον ουτε μαθητον , αλλα παραγιγνεται τοις ανθρωποις
by nature or in some other way ?

φυσει η τινι αλλω τροπω ;

Socrates: O Meno , on the one hand , in times past the Thessalians were famous and admired

Ω Μενων , μεν προ του Θετταλοι ησαν ευδοκιμοι και εθαυμαζοντο
by the Hellenes for their horsemanship and their riches ; but now on the other hand , as it appears to me ,

70B εν τοις Ελλησι εφ' ιππικη τε και πλουτω , νυν δε , ως δοκει εμοι ,
they are also famous for their wisdom , and not the least , the citizens of your companion Aristippus ,
και επι σοφια , και ουχ ηκιστα του πολιται σου εταιρου Αριστιππου
the Larissaeans . But Gorgias has brought this about for you . For when he came to that city, the leading
οι Λαρισαιοι . δε Γοργιας εστι αιτιος τουτου υμιν : γαρ αφικομενος εις την πολιν τους πρωτους
men of the family of Aleuas , to which thine lover Aristippus belongs , and the rest of the Thessalians

Αλευαδων , ων σος ο εραστης Αριστιππος εστιν , και των αλλων Θετταλων
fell in love with his wisdom . And surely then he has also accustomed you to the habit of answering
ειληφεν εραστης επι σοφια : και δη και ειθικεν το εθος αποκρινεσθαι
in a fearless and grand style -if one happens to know what is being asked- as it befits those who **know** ,

70C αφοβως τε και μεγαλοπρεπως , εαν τις τι ερηται , ωσπερε εικος τους **ειδοτας** ,
in as much as he also avails self for questioning by any Hellene who so chooses , on any subject

ατε και παρεχων αυτος ερωταν των Ελληνων τω βουλομενω , ο τι αν τις
they choose , and no one at all ever goes unanswered . But here at Athens , O dear Meno , we are kept
βουληται , και ουδενι οτω ουκ αποκρινομενος . δε ενθαδε , ω φιλε Μενων , περιεστηκεν
in the opposite way , for we are in *a certain dry spell* as it were of wisdom , so that the wisdom seems

71A το εναντιον : γεγονεν τις αυχμος ωσπερ της σοφιας , και η σοφια οιχεσθαι
to have moved from this place to yours . For I am certain that if you were to ask any person here

κινδυνευει εκ τωνδε των τοπων παρ' υμας : γουν ει εθελεις ερεσθαι τινα των ενθαδε
such a question , there is no one at all who would not laugh and say : "O Stranger , I dare say that

ουτως , ουδεις οστις ου γελασεται και ερει : ω ξενε , κινδυνευω
it appears to thee that I am somehow **Blessed** , so as to be able to say whether **Excellence** can be taught ,

δοkein σοι ειναι τις μακαριος , γουν ειτε αρετην ειθ' διδακτον
or in what way **It** comes to be known . Thus , I stand in need of **knowing** this ; whether **Excellence** is

οτω τροπω παραγιγνεται **ειδεναι** : δε εγω δεω **ειδεναι** τοσουτον ειτε
teachable or not teachable , so that neither do I happen to **know** what in the world is Self **Excellence** ."
διδακτον ειτε μη διδακτον , ωστ' ουδε τυγχανω **ειδως** ο τι ποτ' το παραπαν εστι αυτο αρετη .

Thus I, O Meno, since Self has to be in such a Reality as This, am also as poor as the rest of
71B ουν Εγω, ω Μενων, αυτος εχω ουτως του πραγματος τουτου, συμπενομαι
the citizens; and I reproach myself since I know nothing at all about Virtue. Thus, if I do not know
τοις πολιταις, και καταμεμφομαι εμαυτον ως ειδως ουκ το παραπαν περι αρετης: δε μη οйда
that which It is, how indeed can I know Its Qualities/Kinds/Types? Or does it appear to be possible
τι ο εστι, πως γε αν ειδειην τι οποιον; η τε δοκει ειναι οιον
to thee that if there is nothing at all one recognized about Meno, then could this person know whether
σοι, οστις εστι μη το παραπαν οστις γγνωσκει Μενωνα, τουτον ειδεναι ειτε
Meno is handsome or rich and noble, or whether he has the opposite of these qualities?
εστιν καλος ειτε πλουσιος και γενναιος, ειτε και ταναντια τουτων;
Does this appear to be possible to thee?

δοκει τ' ειναι οιον σοι;

Men: Not as far as I am concerned. But does thou truly, O Socrates, not know whatever virtue is?

71C Ουκ εμοιγε. αλλα συ αληθως, ω Σωκρατες, ουδ' οισθα ο τι αρετη εστιν,
Then are we to return home with this report about thee?

αλλα απαγγελωμεν οικαδε και ταυτα περι σου;

Soc: Not only that indeed, O companion, but you may also say that, as far as I am concerned,

Μη μονον γε, ω εταιρε, αλλα και οτι, ως εμοι δοκω,
I have not, up until the present time, encountered anyone who knows,

ουδ' πω ενετυχον αλλω ειδοτι.

Men: What then? You did not encounter Gorgias when he was here at Athens?

Τι δε; ουκ ενετυχες Γοργια οτε ην ενθαδε;

Soc: I did indeed. (Εγωγε.)

Men: Did it not appear to thee at that time that he knew?

ουκ εδοκει σοι Ειτα ειδεναι;

Soc: I do not quite remember, O Meno, so that at the present time, I am unable to say, how

ειμι Ου πανυ μνημων, ω Μενων, ωστε εν τω παροντι ουκ εχω ειπειν, πως
he appeared to me at that time. But perhaps he did know, and perhaps thou knows what he said.

εδοξεν μοι τοτε. αλλ' ισως εκεινος οιδε, τε και συ α εκεινος ελεγεν:
Therefore, please remind me, of what he said. But if you wish, tell me yourself;

71D ουν αναμνησον με, πως ελεγεν. δε ει βουλει, ειπε αυτος:
for it appears beyond a doubt that thou thinks just as he does.

γαρ δοκει δηπου σοι απερ εκεινω.

Men: As far as I am concerned. (Εμοιγε.)

Soc: Now then, on the one hand, let us leave him aside, since he is not here, and on the other hand,

τοιουν μεν Εκεινον εωμεν, επειδη απεστιν: και δε
in the Name of The Gods, O Meno, what does Thine Self claim Virtue to be? Speak and do not
προς θεων, ω Μενων, τι συ αυτος φης αρετην ειναι; ειπον και μη
hold back, in order that I find myself the victim of a most fortunate falsehood, when on the one hand,
φθονησης, ινα ευτυχεστατον εψευσμενος ψευσμα, ω μεν
thou and Gorgias may be revealed as knowing; although on the other hand, I have just now been saying
συ και Γοργιας αν φανης ειδως, δε εγω ειρηκως
that I have never encountered anybody who knows.

μηδενι πωποτε εντετυχηκεναι ειδοτι.

Men: But it is not difficult, O Socrates, to state. First of all, if you wish, the virtue of a man,

71E Αλλ' ου χαλεπον, ω Σωκρατες, ειπειν. πρωτον μεν, ει βουλει αρετην ανδρος,
may be easily stated. This is the virtue of a man; that he must be competent enough to manage
ραδιον, αυτη εστιν αρετη ανδρος, οτι ειναι ικανον πραττειν

the affairs of his city , and while managing those affairs , that he should on the one hand , do good
τα της πολεως , και πραττοντα τους μεν ποιειν ευ
to his friends , but on the other hand , bring harm to his enemies ; and self must be careful to not ever
φιλους , δ' κακως τους εχθρους , και αυτον ευλαβεισθαι μηδεν
suffer such harm . Second of all , a woman's virtue , if you wish , is not difficult to describe , that
παθειν τοιουτον . δε γυναικος αρετην , ει βουλει ου χαλεπον διελθειν , οτι
self must keep her household in good order ; preserving that which is within , and by being obedient
αυτην δει οικειν την οικιαν ευ , σωζουσιν τα ενδον τε και ουσαν κατηκοον
to her man . And there is another virtue for the child , whether a girl or a boy , and another for an older
του ανδρος . και εστι αλλη αρετη παιδος , και θηλειας και αρρενος , και πρεσβυτερον
man , and if you wish on the one hand , one for a free-person , and if you wish , on the other hand , one
ανδρος , ει βουλει μεν , ελευθερου , ει βουλει δε
for a slave . And there are very many other virtues ; so that there is no difficulty in explaining about
72A δουλου . και εισιν παμπολλαι αλλαι αρεται , ωστε εστιν ουκ απορια ειπειν περι
what virtue is ; for there is a virtue for each of us , depending upon our occupation and our age ,
ο τι αρετης εστι : γαρ εστιν η αρετη εκαστω ημων καθ' εκαστην των πραξεων και των ηλικιων
and the activity related to each . And I believe , that the same may also be said about vice , O Socrates .
εργον προς εκαστον : δε οιμαι , ωσαυτως και η κακια . ω Σωκρατες .
Soc: It appears that I must be very fortunate indeed , O Meno , if in searching for a *Singular Virtue* ,
εοικα κεχρησθαι Πολλη ευτυχια γε , ω Μενων , ει ζητων τινη μιαν αρετην
I have discovered a *Swarm* of *virtues* there in thine keeping . But yet , O Meno , according to this image
ανηυρηκα τι σμηνος αρετων παρα σοι κειμενων . αταρ , ω Μενων , κατα ταυτην την εικονα
of the *Swarm* , if I were to ask of you concerning , *what in the world* is *The Ousia/Self Nature* of a Bee ?
72B περι τα σμηνη , ει μου ερομενου περι ο τι ποτ' εστι ουσιας μελιττης ,
And if you were to answer that there are many *different* species of *Selves* , what would you answer me ,
και ελεγες ειναι πολλας και παντοδαπας αυτας , τι αν απεκρινω μοι ,
if I then asked , “Does thou say that it is *by this* , *by Being Bees* , that there are many species of *Bees* that
ει ηρομην αρα σε φης τουτω τω ειναι μελιττας ειναι πολλας και παντοδαπας
are also *different* from each other ? Or on the one hand , it is *not by this* ; *by Being Bees* , but rather they
και διαφερουσας αλληλων ; η μεν ουδεν τουτω , δε
are *different* in some other way , such as for example , either by their *beauty* , or by their *size* , or by
διαφερουσιν τω αλλω , οιον η καλλει , η μεγεθει η
some *other* such like *quality* ? Tell me , what would you answer if you were questioned in this way ?
τω αλλω των τοιουτων ; ειπε , τι αν απεκρινω ερωτηθεις ουτως ;
Men: This , as far as I am concerned ; that they are *not different* from each other *by Being Bees* .
Τουτ' εγωγε , οτι ουδεν διαφερουσιν , η ετερα της ετερας , η εισιν μελιτται .
Soc: Therefore , if I were to say after this ; “Now then , tell me , what *Is This Self* , O Meno ;
72C ουν Ει ειπον μετα ταυτα : τοιουν ειπε μοι τι ειναι τουτο αυτο , ω Μενων ,
according to which they are *not different* , but according to which , you say , they *Are All The Same* ;
ω ουδεν διαφερουσιν αλλα φης εισιν απασαι ταυτον ;
Of course , you would be able to give me an answer ?
δηπου αν ειχες ειπειν μοι τι ;
Men: I would indeed .
Εγωγε .
Soc: Surely then , in this way also concerning *The Virtues* , even if *They* are *many* and *different* ,
δη Ουτω και περι των αρετων , καν ει εισιν πολλαι και παντοδαπαι
They would indeed *All* possess *A Singular Idea* that is *The Same* , according to which *They Are Virtues* ;
γε απασαι εχουσι τι εν ειδος ταυτον δι' ο εισιν αρεται ,

and towards which the one who answers , will certainly do Well to Keep Their Eye Fixed Upon in order
εις ο τον αποκρινομενον που τυγχανει καλως εχει αποβλεψαντα τω
to answer that question clearly , “What **Is The Being of Virtue**?” . Or do you not understand what I say ?

72D ερωτησαντι εκεινο δηλωσαι ο ουσα αρετη : η ου μανθανεις ο τι λεγω ;

Men: I do indeed appear to me to understand ; however , I do not yet grasp the question as I indeed wish .
γε Δοκω μοι μανθανειν : μεντοι ου πω κατεχω το ερωτωμενον ως γε βουλεται .

Soc: Then is it only *in relation to Virtue* that it appears to thee in this way , O Meno , that there is one for

δε Ποτερον μονον περι αρετης δοκει σοι ουτω , ω Μενων , ειναι μεν αλλη
a man , but another for a woman and for the others , or would you also say that *the same relation* holds
ανδρος , δε αλλη γυναικος και των αλλων , η και οσαυτως περι
for **Health** and for **Size** and for **Strength** ? Does it seem to thee there is one health for a man , but another
υγειας και περι μεγεθους και περι ισχυος ; δοκει σοι ειναι μεν αλλη υγεια ανδρος , δε αλλη
for a woman ? Or is **The Idea of Health The Same Everywhere** , whether in man ,

72E γυναικος ; η εστιν ειδος υγεια ταυτον πανταχου , εανπερ η εαντε εν ανδρι
or in anything at all ?

η εαντε εν αλλω οτωουν ;

Men: It appears to me that **Health** is indeed **The Self/Same** , in both man and woman .

δοκει μοι υγεια ειναι γε Η αυτη και ανδρος και γυναικος .

Soc: And is this not also the case *in relation to* both **Size** and **Strength** ? For if a woman is strong ,

και Ουκουν και μεγεθος και ισχυς ; εανπερ γυνη η ισχυρα
then she will be strong according to **The Same Idea** and **The Same Strength** ? For by “**The Same**”

εσται ισχυρα τω αυτω ειδει και τη αυτη ισχυι ; γαρ τη αυτη
I mean this : That **Strength does not differ** insofar as **It Is Strength** , whether it exists in a man or
λεγω τουτο : το ισχυς ουδεν διαφερει προς ειναι η ισχυς , εαντε η εν ανδρι εαντε
in a woman . Or does it appear to thee to **differ** in some way ?

εν γυναικι : η δοκει σοι διαφερειν τι ;

Men: Not to me indeed . (Ουκ εμοιγε .)

Soc: Then will **Excellence** differ in any way *in relation to Being Excellence* , whether **It exists**

73A δε Η αρετη διοισει τι προς το ειναι αρετη , εαντε η
in a child or in an elder , or whether **It exists** in a woman , or in a man ?

εν παιδι εαντε εν πρεσβυτη , εαντε εν γυναικι εαντε εν ανδρι ;

Men: Somehow it seems to me indeed , O Socrates , that this case is no longer **like** those other cases .

πως δοκει Εμοιγε , ω Σωκρατες , τουτο ειναι ουκετι ομοιον τοις τουτοις αλλοις .

Soc: What then? Did you not say that on the one hand , the **Virtue** of a man was to manage his city **Well** ,

Τι δε ; ουκ ελεγες μεν αρετην ανδρος διοικειν πολιν ευ ,
while on the other hand , the virtue of a woman was to manage her home **Well** ?

δε γυναικος οικιαν ;

Men: I did indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Take notice then , can either city or home or anything else be managed **Well** , apart from being

Αρ’ ουν οιον η πολιν η οικιαν η οτιουν αλλο διοικειν ευ , μη

Being Managed in a **Soundminded** and in a **Righteous Way** ?

73B διοικουντα σωφρονως τε και δικαιως ;

Men: Certainly not . (Ου δητα .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that whoever Manages **Justly** and **Soundmindedly** ,

Ουκουν ανπερ διοικωσι δικαιως και σωφρονως ,

Are Those who Manage with **Righteousness** and **Soundmindedness** .

διοικησουσιν δικαιοσυνη και σωφροσυνη :

Men: It is **necessary** . (Αναγκη) .

Soc: Accordingly then , both *women* and *men* , are in need of both of **The Selves**
αρα και η γυνη και ο ανηρ , δεονται αμφοτεροι των αυτων
-of **Righteousness** and of **Soundmindedness**- if indeed *they are going to Be Good* .
δικαιοσυνης και σωφροσυνης , ειπερ μελλουσιν ειναι αγαθοι .

Men: Apparently . (Φαινονται .)

Soc: What then about the *young* and *old* ? Can *they ever come to Be Good* by being undisciplined and
Τι δε παις και πρεσβυτης ; μων αν ποτε γενοιντο αγασθoi οντες ακολαστοι και
unjust . (αδικοι ;)

Men: Surely not . (Ου δητα .)

Soc: Then **Soundminded** and **Just** ?

Αλλα σωφρονες και δικαιοι ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Accordingly then , *All* human-beings **Are Good** in **The Self/Same Way** ;

73C αρ' Παντες ανθρωποι εισι αγαθοι τω αυτω τροπω :
for they come to **Be Good** when they happen upon **The Selves** .
γαρ γιγονται αγαθοι τυχοντες των αυτων .

Men: So it seems . (Εοικεν .)

Soc: Then what if **The Self Virtue** was not indeed of **Selves** ,
αν ει η αυτη αρετη ην μη γε αυτων
then without a doubt , people would **not Be Good** in **The Self/Same Way** .
αν δηπου Ουκ ησαν αγαθοι τω αυτω τροπω .

Men: Surely not . (Ου δητα .)

Soc: Now then , seeing that **The Self/Same Virtue exists** for *All* ,
τοιουν Επειδη η αυτη αρετη εστι παντων ,
try to say and remember , what Gorgias and thee along with that man declare **Self to Be** .
πειρω ειπειν και αναμνησθηναι , τι Γοργιας και συ μετ εκεινου φησι αυτο ειναι .

Men: What else indeed , than to be able **to rule** human-beings ?

Τι αλλο γ' η ειναι οιον τ' αρχειν των ανθρωπων ;
If **indeed** you are searching for **One Certain/Specific Aspect that Applies to All** .

73D ειπερ γε ζητεις εν τι κατα παντων .

Soc: Why certainly this is **indeed** what I seek . But does **this same virtue** also **apply** to a child , O Meno ,
Αλλα μην γε ζητω . αλλ' αρα η αυτη αρετη και παιδος , ω Μενων ,
and to a slave , in such a way that he is also able **rule** his master . and would that slave still appear to thee
και δουλου , οιω ειναι τε αρχειν του δεσποτου , και αν ετι δοκει σοι
to be a slave when he is **ruling** ?

ειναι δουλός ο αρχων ;

Men: He does not appear to me to be a slave at all , O Socrates .

Ου δοκει μοι πανυ , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: For it is not reasonable , O Best Friend . Now once more consider the following , you state that ,
γαρ Ου εικος , ω αριστε . γαρ ετι και σκοπει τοδε : φης
virtue is "to be able to govern"; shall we not add **This Very Self** ; **"Justly"** , but **never** unjustly"?
ειναι οιον τ' αρχειν : ου προσθησομεν το αυτοσε δικαιως , δε μη αδικως ;

Men: I do indeed believe so . For **righteousness** , O Socrates , is **virtue** .

Οιμαι εγωγε : γαρ η δικαιοσυνη , ω Σωκρατες , εστιν αρετη .

Soc: Which one , O Meno , **Virtue** or **A Particular Virtue** ?

73E Ποτερον , ω Μενων , αρετη η τις αρετη ;

Men: What do you mean by this ?

Πως λεγεις τουτο ;

Soc: Just as in any other case . Such as for example , *Roundness* , if you wish . I at least would say ,
Ως περι οτουουν αλλου . οιον περι στρογγυλοτητος , ει βουλει , εγωγε αν ειποιμ' ,
that it is *a particular shape* , and in this way signify that it is *not Simply Shape* . Therefore , by this
οτι εστι τι σχημα , ουτως οτι ουχ απλως σχημα . δε δια ταυτα
I would thus signify , that there are also *other shapes* .

Men: Thou would indeed be speaking correctly , since I also say that there is *not only righteousness* ,
συ γε λεγων Ορθως , επει εγω και λεγω ου μονον δικαιοσυνην
since there are also *other virtues* .
αλλα ειναι και αλλας αρετας .

Soc: What are they ? Tell me . And in such a way , that I would also tell you the *other shapes* ,
74A Τινας ταυτας ; ειπε : και οιον εγω αν και ειποιμι σοι αλλα σχηματα ,
if you would take that request from me . Therefore , thou also tell me what are the other virtues .
ει κελευοις με : ουν συ και ειπε εμοι αλλας αρετας .

Men: Now then as far as I am concerned , Courage and Soundmindedness and Wisdom and
τοιουν εμοιγε Η ανδρεια και σωφροσυνη και σοφια και
Magnanimity and a great many others appear to be a Virtue .
μεγαλοπρεπεια και παμπολλαι αλλαι δοκαι ειναι αρετη .

Soc: O Meno , we are undergoing *the same* experience ; since again we have found *many* virtues
ω Μενων , πεπονθαμεν ταυτον : αυ Παλιν ηυρηκαμεν πολλας αρετας
while searching for *one* , only this time , in a different way than before . However , we are unable
ζητουντες μιαν , νυνδε αλλον τροπον η : δε , ου δυναμεθα
to discover , *the one* that *exists* throughout *All* of them .
ανευρειν , την μιαν η εστιν δια παντων τουτων .

Men: Because I am unable to find in what way you carry out thine search , in order to grasp
74B γαρ Ου δυναμαι πω συ ζητεις ως λαβειν
one single virtue that applies to all , just as in the other cases .

μιαν αρετην κατα παντων , ωσπερ εν τοις αλλοις .
Soc: Reasonably indeed . But if I am able , I will eagerly lead us forward . This happens , because you
Εικοτως γε : αλλ' εαν οιος τ' ω , εγω προθυμησομαι ημας προβιβασαι , γαρ
certainly understand , that this line of inquiry applies to everything . For if someone were to ask thee
που μανθανεις , οτι ουτωσι εχει περι παντος . ει τις ανεροιτο σε
this , which I mentioned just now , “What is *Shape* , O Meno ?” and if you were to answer Self that it is
τουτο , ο εγω ελεγον νυνδη , τι εστι σχημα , ω Μενων ; ει ειπες αυτω οτι
roundness , and if he responded to you just as I did by asking , whether *roundness* is *Shape*
στρογγυλοτης , ει ειπιν σοι απερ εγω ποτερον η στρογγυλοτης εστιν σχημα
or *a particular shape* ?” You would without a doubt answer that *it is a particular shape* .
η τι σχημα ; αν δηπου ειπες οτι τι σχημα .

Men: Very much so indeed . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that because of this , there are also *other shapes* ?

74C Ουκουν οτι δια ταυτα , εστι και αλλα σχηματα ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And if he indeed proceeded to ask thee , what kind they were , you would tell him .

Και ει γε προσανηρωτα σε οποια , αν ελεγες ;

Men: I would indeed .

Εγωγε .

Soc: And in turn , if he were to ask in a similar way about *Color* , what *It Is* , and thou were to answer ,
Και αυ ει ανηρετο ωσαυτως περι χρωματος ο τι εστι , και σου ειποντος ,

that it is that which is white , and after this the questioner asked whether white is **Color** or
οτι το λευκον , μετα ταυτα ο ερωτων υπελαβεν ποτερον το λευκον εστιν χρωμα η
a particular color ? You would say that it is **a particular color** , because there also happen to be **others** ?
τι χρωμα ; αν ειπες οτι τι χρωμα , διοτι και τυγχανει οντα αλλα ;

Men : I would indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: And if indeed he urged you to tell him the **other colors** , you would mention the others ;

74D Και ει γε εκελευε σε λεγειν αλλα χρωματα , αν ελεγες αλλα ,
which happen to be no less **colors** than the white .

ω τυγχανει οντα ουδεν ηττον χρωματα του λευκου ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then if he pursued **The Logos** just as I do , and said that , we always arrive at **many** ,

ουν ει μετηι τον λογον ωσπερ εγω , και ελεγεν οτι αι αφικνουμεθα εις πολλα ,

but that is not the way for me , seeing that you call **these many** by **One certain Name** ,

αλλα μη ουτως μοι , αλλ' επειδη προσαγορευεις ταυτα τα πολλα ενι τινι ονοματι ,

and say that there is **not** one of them which is **not** a **shape** , even when they are opposed to one another .

και φης ουδεν αυτων ο τι ειναι ου σχημα , και και ταυτα οντα εναντια αλληλοις ,

What is **This** , which applies no less to the round than it does to the straight , and which you call **Shape** ,

ο τι εστι τουτο , ο κατεχει ουδεν ηττον το στρογγυλον η το ευθυ , και ο ονομαζεις σχημα

since you say that the round is no more a shape than the straight ? Or would you not say it in this way ?

74E δη φης το στρογγυλον ειναι ουδεν μαλλον σχημα η το ευθυ ; η ουχ λεγεις ουτω ;

Men: I would indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Take notice then , when you speak in this way , do you say at that time that the round is round

Αρ' ουν , οταν λεγης ουτω , φης τοτε το στρογγυλον ειναι στρογγυλον
no more than the straight , or that the straight is no more straight than the round ?

ουδεν μαλλον η ευθυ , το ευθυ ουδε ευθυ η στρογγυλον ;

Men: Of course not , O Socrates . (Ου δηπου , ω Σωκρατες .)

Soc: Then certainly , you say that the round **shape** is indeed no more a **shape** than the straight ,

Αλλα μην φης το στρογγυλον σχημα ειναι γε ουδεν μαλλον του ευθεος ,
nor the other than the other ?

ουδε το ετερον του ετερου .

Men: You speak the truth .

λεγεις Αληθη .

Soc: Then what in the world is **This** , which has this name of **Shape** ? Please try to say . Then , if you

ουν Τι ποτε εστι τουτο , ου τουτο ονομα το σχημα ; πειρω λεγειν . ουν ει
responded in this way to the questioner about either **Shape** or **Color** , “But I at least do not understand

ειπες ουτως τω ερωτωντι περι η σχηματος η χρωματος οτι αλλ' εγωγε ουδε μανθανω
what it is you want , dear sir , nor do I know what it is you mean.” Then , he would probably have been

75A ο τι βουλει , ω ανθρωπε , ουδε οйда ο τι λεγεις : αν ισως
amazed and responded , “You do not understand , that I am searching for **That** which is **The Same** in
εθαυμασε και ειπειν : ου μανθανεις , οτι ζητω το ταυτον επι

all these cases ?” Or would you still have nothing to say about these cases , O Meno , if someone asked ,
πασι τουτοις ; η αν εχοις ουδε ειπειν επι τουτοις , ω Μενων , ει τις ερωτωη :

“What is **The Same** which applies to **All** ; to the round and the straight and to those other aspects ,

τι εστιν ταυτον επι πασι , επι τω στρογγυλω και ευθει και επι τοις αλλοις ,

which you surely call **shapes** ?” Try to answer , in order that thou may also have some practice for

α δη καλεις σχηματα ; πειρω ειπειν , ινα σοι και γενηται μελετη
the answer about **Virtue/Excellence** .

την αποκρισιν περι της αρετης .

Men: No , but thou go ahead and answer , O Socrates .

75B Μη , αλλα συ ειπε , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Do you wish I do this favor for thee ;

Βουλει χαρισωμαι σοι ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε.)

Soc: Then will thou also be willing to tell me about **Virtue/Excellence** ?

ουν συ και Εθελησεις ειπειν εμοι περι της αρετης ;

Men: I will indeed . (Εγωγε.)

Soc: Now then , one must be willing , for it is worth our effort .

τοιυνυν Προθυμητεον : γαρ αξιον .

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ μεν ουν .)

Soc: Come along then , **We** will try to explain to thee , what **Shape** is . Then consider if you will accept

Φερε δη , πειρωμεθα ειπειν σοι , τι σχημα εστι . ουν σκοπει ει αποδεχη
that **Self** is the following . For surely , let this be the case **for Us** ;

αυτο ειναι τοδε : γαρ δη εστω τουτο ημιν

Shape/Figure is The Only One of **The Truly-Existing Beings** which **Always** happens to follow **Color** .

σχημα μονον των οντων ο αι τυγχανει επομενον χρωματι .

Does that suffice for thee , or do you search in some other way ? For if you were to speak about

ικανως σοι , η ζητεις αλλως πως ; γαρ ει ειποις

Excellence/Virtue in the way I spoke about **Shape** , then I will be **Well-Pleased** .

αρετην ουτως εγω καν αγαπων .

Men: But this is indeed a simple-minded answer , O Socrates .

74C Αλλα τουτο γε ευηθες , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: What do you mean ? (Πως λεγεις ;)

Men: Because **Shape** is in some way , according to thine **Logos** , that which always follows **Color** .

Οτι σχημα εστι που κατα τον σον λογον , ο αι επεται χροα .

But then if someone were to say that they did not know what color is , but were in the same difficulty

δε δη ει τις φαιη μη ειδεναι την χροαν , αλλα ωσαυτως αποροι
just as they were in about shape . Well then , what do you think you would have answered ?

ωσπερ περι του σχηματος , ειεν : τι οiei σοι αν αποκεκρισθαι ;

Soc: **The Truth** as far as I am concerned . And if on the one hand , the questioner were indeed one

Ταληθη εγωγε : και ει μεν ο ερομενος ειη γε τις
of the wise ones of the eristic and antagonistic kind , I would say to him that : “On the one hand ,

των σοφων και εριστικων τε και αγωνιστικων , αν ειποιμ’ αυτω οτι μεν
my answer has been stated , but on the other hand , if I did not state it correctly , it is thine task/work

74D εμοι ειρηται : δε ει μη λεγω ορθως , σον εργον
to take up **The Logos** and refute me . Whereas on the other hand , if we were **Friends** , and we chose to
λαμβάνειν λογον και ελεγχειν . δε ει οντες φιλοι τε βουλοιντο

be **Discoursing** with each other just as thou and I are now doing , then I must reply in a **More Gentle Way**

διαλεγεσθαι αλληλοις ωσπερ συ και εγω νυνι , δη δει αποκρινεσθαι πραοτερον πως
and **More in The Way of The Dialectician** . Thus , **The More Dialectical Way** , is not only to answer

και διαλεκτικωτερον . δε το διαλεκτικωτερον μη μονον αποκρινεσθαι

The Truth , but **Equally** to also proceed by means of those premises which the one who is questioning

ταληθη , αλλα ισως και δι’ εκεινων ων ο ερωτωμενος
acknowledges they know . And surely this is The Way in which I shall endeavor to converse with thee .

προσομολογη ειδεναι . και δη ουτως εγω πειρασομαι ειπειν σοι .

For tell me ; do you call something an end /termination/boundary ? I mean such as the
γαρ λεγε μοι : καλεις τι τελευτην ; λεγω οιον
following example , a limit or an extremity . By all these words I mean something that is **The Same** .

75E τοιονδε περας και εσχατον : παντα ταυτα λεγω τι ταυτον :
Although Prodicus may perhaps differ with us . But you would most certainly describe something as
δ' Προδικος αν ισως διαφεροιτο ημιν : αλλα συ γε που καλεις τι
having been bounded and having been completed . This is what I wish to say , nothing complicated .
πεπερανθαι και τετελευτηκεναι : το τοιουτον βουλομαι λεγειν , ουδεν ποικιλον .

Men: But I do so describe them ; and I believe that I understand that which you mean .

Αλλα καλω , και οιμαι μανθανειν ο λεγεις .

Soc: What next ? Do you call something a plane , and another in turn a solid , like they do in geometry ?

76A Τι δ' ; καλεις τι επιπεδον , και ετερον αυ στερεον , οιον τα ταυτα εν γεωμετριας ;

Men: I do indeed call those things by those names . (Εγωγε καλω .)

Soc: Now then , out of these admissions you may already understand what I mean by **Shape** .

τοιουν εκ τουτων αν Ηδη μαθοις ο μου λεγω σχημα .

For my explanation will apply to **Every Shape** : for that by which a solid is bounded , is **Shape** .

γαρ λεγω τουτο κατα παντος σχηματος , γαρ τουτο εις ο το στερεον περαινει , ειναι σχημα :
So that in putting it together , I would say that **Shape** is **The Very/Just as** Boundary/Limit of a solid .

συλλαβων αν ειποιμι σχημα ειναι οπερ περας στερεου .

Men: Then what do you say color is , O Socrates ?

δε τι λεγεις Το χρωμα , ω Σωκρατες ;

Soc: You are indeed overbearing , O Meno ! For you task an old man with demands for answers ,

ει γ' Υβριστης , ω Μενων : πραγματα πρεσβυτη ανδρι προσταττεις αποκρινεσθαι ,
since you are un-willing to recall to say , what in the world **Self** is that Gorgias claims **Virtue** to be .

76B δε ουκ εθελεις αναμνησθεις ειπειν , ο τι ποτε αυτος Γοργιας λεγει αρετην ειναι .

Men: After thou have answered this for me , O Socrates , then I will tell thee .

επειδαν συ ειπης τουτ' μοι , ω Σωκρατες , Αλλ' ερω σοι .

Soc: By the way you carry on a conversation , O Meno , even one who is blindfolded could recognize
διαλεγομενου , ω Μενων , Καν τις κατακεκαλυμμενος γνοιη
that you are handsome and still have lovers .

οτι σοι ει καλος και ετι εισιν ερασται .

Men: Why so ? (Τι δη;)

Soc: Because you do nothing except assign tasks in these statements , which is what spoiled people do ,

Οτι ουδεν αλλ' η επιταττεις εν τοις λογοις : οπερ οι τρυφωντες ποιουσιν ,
inasmuch as they are tyrannical , so long as they are in the flower of their bloom . And at the same time ,

ατε τυραννευοντες , εως αν εν ωρα ωσι . και αμα
you have probably recognized in me , that I am at a disadvantage with those that are beautiful .

76C ισως κατεγνωκας εμου , οτι ειμι ηττων των καλων .

Therefore , I will do thee a favor and I will answer .

ουν χαριουμαι σοι και αποκρινουμαι .

Men: Then you must certainly do me that favor .

ουν μεν Πανυ χαρισαι .

Soc: Therefore , do you wish that I answer thee in the Gorgian mode , which thou would easily follow ?

ουν Βουλει αποκρινωμαι σοι κατα Γοργιαν , η συ αν μαλιστα ακολουθησαις ;

Men: I do so wish , how could I not ?

Βουλομαι : πως γαρ ου ;

Soc: Do both of you say , as Empedocles , that there are certain **Flows/Streams** of **The Real-Beings** ?

Ουκουν λεγετε κατα Εμπεδοκλεια τινας απορροας των οντων ;

Men: Emphatically so indeed . (Σφοδρά γε .)

Soc: And passages , *into which* and *through which* these **Flows** pass/travel through ?

Και πορους , εις ους και δι' ων αι απορροαι πορευονται ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: And on the one hand , some of **The Streams** , *Harmonically fit* into the passages ,

Και μεν τας των απορροων αρμοττειν ενιοις των πορων ,
while on the other hand , some are too small or too big ?

76D δε τας ειναι ελαττους η μειζους ;

Men: This is so . (ταυτα Εστι .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that there is also something you call *sight/vision* ?

Ουκουν και τι καλιδες οψιν ;

Men: I do indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Surely then , from these statements , “Conceive/Connect that which I mean/say”, as Pindar says .

δη Εκ τουτων ξυνεξ(συνιημι) τοι ο λεγω , Πινδαρος εφη .

For Color is The Flow from Shapes that is Symmetrical and Perceptible to sight .
γαρ χροα εστι απορρη σχηματων συμμετρος και αισθητος οψει .

Men: That , O Socrates , appears to me to be *the best answer* you have stated .

ταυτην , ω Σωκρατες , δοκεις μοι Αριστα την αποκρισιν ειρηκεναι .

Soc: Probably because it is spoken in a style to which thou art accustomed , and at the same time ,

Ισως γαρ ειρηται κατα σοι συνηθειαν : και αμα ,
I think you realize , that from *self* , you will be able to state what both *sound* and *smell* are ,
οιμαι , εννοεις , οτι εξ αυτης αν εχοις ειπειν ο και φωνην και οσμην εστι ,
as well as all *the other senses* .

76E και πολλα αλλα των τοιουτων .

Men: Entirely so . (Πανυ μεν ουν .)

Soc: For the answer is theatrically tragic, O Meno, so that it pleases thee more than the one about **Shape** .

γαρ η αποκρισις εστιν Τραγικη , ω Μενων , ωστε αρεσκει σοι μαλλον η η περι του σχηματος .

Men: It does indeed . (Εμοιγε .)

Soc: But it is not , O son of Alexidemus , as I persuade myself , but the former one is *better* . But I think

Αλλ εστιν ουκ , ω παι Αλεξιδημου , ως εγω πειθω εματον , αλλ' εκεινη βελτιων : δε οιμαι
that it would not appear so to thee , just as you were saying yesterday , if it were not necessary for thee

αν ουδ' δοξαι σοι , ωσπερ ελεγες χθες , ει μη , αναγκαιον σοι
to leave before **The Mysteries** , but if you **Remained** and were **Initiated** .

απιεναι προ των μυστηριων , αλλ ει περιμειναις τε και μυηθεις .

Men: But I will remain , O Socrates , if you will give me many such answers .

77A Αλλα αν περιμενοιμ' , ω Σωκρατες , ει μοι λεγοις πολλα τοιαυτα .

Soc: But I will most certainly not be lacking in eagerness to give you such answers , both for thine sake

Αλλα γε μην ουδεν απολειπω προθυμιας , λεγων τοιαυτα , και σου ενεκα
and my own , but I may not be able to give you many such answers in this way . But come along then ,
και εμαυτου , αλλ' μη ουχ εσομαι οιος τ' λεγειν πολλα τοιαυτα οπως . αλλ' ιθι δη
and you must try to fulfill your promise , by telling me concerning , what is **Virtue** as a **Whole** , and as
και συ πειρω αποδουναι την υποσχεσιν , ειπων εμοι περτι ο τι εστι αρετης κατα ολου , και οπερ
those who make jokes say whenever someone breaks something ; stop making *many* out of **One** , but
οι σκωπτοντως φασι εκαστοτε τους συντριβοντας τι , παυσαι ποιων πολλα εκ του ενος , αλλ'
Allow **It** to Remain **Whole** and **Sound** and say what **Virtue Is** . Since you have indeed received

77B εασας ολην και υγιη ειπε τι αρετη εστιν . δε γε ειληφας

The Paradigms/Models/Examples from me .

τα παραδειγματα παρ' εμου .

Men: Now then , it appears to me , O Socrates , that virtue is , just as the poet says ,
τοινυν Δοκει μοι , ω Σωκρατες , αρετη ειναι , καθαπερ ο ποιητης λεγει ,
“To Rejoice in Beautiful and to be Able .”

χαιρειν καλοισι τε και δυνασθαι

And so I say that this is virtue ; desiring beautiful things and to be able to acquire them .

και εγω λεγω τουτο αρετην , επιθυμουντα των καλων ειναι δυνατον ποιζεσθαι .

Soc: Are you saying that one who desires beautiful things is a desirer of good things ?

Αρα λεγεις τον επιθυμουντα των καλων ειναι επιθυμητην αγαθων ;

Men: Especially so indeed . (Μαλιστα γε .)

Soc: Accordingly then , since some people are desirous of bad things , while others desire good things ,

Αρα ως τινων οι οντων επιθυμουςιν των κακων δε οι ετερων των αγαθων ;
not all human-beings , my good man , appear to thee to desire good things ?

77C ου παντες , ωριστε , δοκουσι σοι επιθυμειν των αγαθων ;

Men: Not as far as I am concerned . (Ουκ εμοιγε .)

Soc: Since some are desirous of bad things ?

Αλλα τινες των κακων ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Do you mean , by thinking that the bad things are good , or by actually recognizing ,

λεγεις , Οιομενοι τα κακα ειναι αγαθα , η και γινωσκοντες ,
that they are bad , but nevertheless , go on desiring selves ?

οτι εστιν κακα , ομως επιθυμουςιν αυτων ;

Men: Both it appears , as far as I am concerned .

Αμφοτερα δοκει εμοιγε .

Soc: Since it truly appears to thee , O Meno , that anyone who recognizes that bad things are bad ,

γαρ η δοκει σοι , ω Μενων , τις γινωσκων οτι τα κατα εστιν κακα
would nevertheless desire selves ?

ομως επιθυμειν αυτων ;

Men: Quite so . (Μαλιστα .)

Soc: What do you mean by *to desire* ? Or do you mean *to come to be self* ?

77D Τι λεγεις επιθυμειν ; η γενεσθαι αυτω ?

Men: *To come to be* . For what else can it mean ?

Γενεσθαι : γαρ τι αλλο ;

Soc: Is there anyone who is led to believe that bad things benefit the one who becomes bad ,

Ποτερον ηγουμενος τα κακα ωφελειν εκεινον ω αν γενηται ,
or do they recognize that bad things harm the one in whom bad things would be present ?

η γινωσκων οτι τα κακα βλαπει ω αν παρη ;

Men: There are those , on the one hand , who are led to believe that bad things benefit ,

Εισι οι μεν ηγουμενοι τα κακα ωφελειν ,
and those , on the other hand , who recognize that bad things do harm .

και οι δε γινωσκοντες οτι βλαπει .

Soc: And do they really appear to thee to recognize , that bad things are bad ,

και η δοκουσι σοι γινωσκειν , οτι τα κακα εστιν κακα ,
when they are led to believe that bad things are beneficial ?

οι ηγουμενοι τα κακα ωφελειν ;

Men: They indeed do not at all appear like this to me .

γε Ου πανυ δοκει τουτο μοι .

Soc: Is it not clear then , on the one hand , that these people *do not* desire **bad** things , since they are

Ουκουν δηλον μεν οτι ουτοι ου επιθυμουσιν των κακων , οι
unaware , that selves are **bad** , but they desire those things which they think are **good** , whereas
αγνοουντες **αυτα** , αλλα εκεινων , α ωοντο ειναι αγαθα ,
on the other hand , they are *indeed bad* ? So that it is clear that those who are unaware that **selves**
77E δε ταυτα εστι γε κακα : ωστε δηλον οτι οι αγνοουντες **αυτα**
are **bad** , and instead think that **selves** are **good** , desire **good** things . Or do you disagree ?

και οιομενοι ειναι αγαθα , επιθυμουσιν των αγαθων : η ου ;

Men: It is quite possible in their case . (Κινδυνευουσιν γε ουτοι .)

Soc: What next then ? On the one hand , as thou says , those who go on desiring **bad** things ,

Τι δε ; μεν , ως συ φης , οι επιθυμουντες των κακων ,
are on the other hand , being led to believe that **bad** things **harm** the one who becomes **bad** ,
δε ηγουμενοι τα κακα βλαπειν , εκεινον ω αν γιγνηται ,
by recognizing , without a doubt , that they will be **harmed** by **bad** things ?

γιγνωσκουσι δηπου οτι βλαβησονται υπ' αυτων ;

Men: Necessarily . (Αναγκη .)

Soc: But do they not think that those who are **harmed** are **miserable** to the degree that they are **harmed** ?

78A Αλλα ουτοι ουκ οιονται τους βλαπτομενους ειναι αθλιους καθ' οσον πλαπτονται ;

Men: This is also necessary . (τουτο Και αναγκη .)

Soc: But are not those that are **miserable** , **mean-spirited** ?

δε ου τους αθλιους κακοδαιμονας ;

Men: I do indeed think so . (Οιμαι εγωγε .)

Soc: Therefore , is there *anyone at all* who wishes to be **miserable** and **mean-spirited** ?

ουν Εστιν οστις βουλεται ειναι αθλιος και κακοδαιμων ;

Men: It does not appear to me to be the case , O Socrates .

Ου δοκει μοι , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Accordingly then it is not the case , that *anyone* wishes for **bad things** , O Meno , unless ,

Αρα Ουκ ουδεις βουλεται τα κακα , ω Μενων , μη
if they do indeed wish to be **in such a condition** . For what else is it to be **miserable** ,

ειπερ βουλεται ειναι τοιουτος . γαρ τι αλλο εστιν ειναι αθλιον
than to desire **bad things** and to **possess/acquire/have/hold/procure/own/get them** .

η επιθυμειν των κακων τε και κτασθαι(κταομαι) ;

Men: What you say is probably true , O Socrates , and *no one* wishes for **bad** things .

78B λεγειν Κινδυνευεις αληθη , ω Σωκρατες : και ουδεις βουλεσθαι τα κακα .

Soc: Were you not saying just now , that

Ουκουν ελεγες δη νυν , οτι

virtue/excellence is to wish for good things and **to be able** ?

η αρετη εστιν βουλεσθαι ταγαθα τε και δυνασθαι ;

Men: Yes , I did say so . (Ειπον γαρ .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that this is saying , on the one hand , that the wishing belongs *to All* of us ,

Ουκουν του λεχθεντος μεν το βουλεσθαι υπαρχει πασιν ,
and in this way indeed , one person is no **better** than another ?

και ταυτη γε ο ετερος ουδεν βελτιων του ετερου ;

Men: So it appears . (Φαινεται .)

Soc: Then it is clear that , if indeed one is **better** than another ,

Αλλα δηλον οτι , ειπερ αλλος εστι βελτιων αλλου ,
then one would be **better** according to **their ability**

αν ειη αμεινον κατα το δυνασθαι .

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Accordingly then , as it is reasonable , according to thine **Logos** , **Virtue/Excellence** is this :
αρα , ως εοικε , κατα σον τον λογον αρετη εστιν Τουτ' ,
The Power of Being Able to Provide Good things .

78C του δυναμης ποριζεσθαι ταγαθα .

Men: It appears to me that it has to be exactly in this way , O Socrates , as thou now understand it .

δοκει μοι εχειν Πανταπασι ουτως , ω Σωκρατες , ως συ νυν υπολαμβανεις .

Soc: And surely then let us see if this that you say is **True** ; for perhaps you may have spoken **Well** .

και δη Ιδωμεν ει τουτο λεγεις αληθες : γαρ ισως αν λεγοις ευ .

You say that to be able to **Provide Good** things is **Virtue/Excellence** ?

φης ειναι οιον τ' ποριζεσθαι ταγαθα αρετην ;

Men: I do indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Then do you not call **Good** things , such things as **Health** and **Wealth** ?

δε ουχι καλεις Αγαθα οιον υγιειαν τε και πλουτον ;

Men: And I include the acquisition of **gold** and **silver** and of **honors** and **offices** in the city .

Και λεγω κτασθαι χρυσιον και αργυριον και τιμας και αρχας εν πολει .

Soc: Do you mean by the **good** things nothing else than **these kind** of things ?

λεγεις ταγαθα αττα Μη αλλ' η τα τοιαυτα ;

Men: I mean nothing else than **all those** such as **these** .

λεγω Ουκ αλλα παντα τα τοιαυτα .

Soc: Very well . Surely then to provide **gold** and **silver** is virtue , as Meno says , the paternal

78D Ειεν : δη ποριζεσθαι χρυσιον και αργυριον εστιν αρετη , ως Μενων φησι ο πατρικος guest-friend , of the Great-King . Do you add to this providing , O Meno , in a **Just**

ξενος του μεγαλου βασιλεως . ποτερον προστιθεις τω τουτω πορω , ω Μενων , το δικαιως and **Pious** Way , or does it make no difference to thee , even if someone provides **selves unjustly** , και οσιως , η ουδεν διαφερει σοι , αλλα καν τις ποριζεται αυτα αδικως , you still call **selves** virtue/excellence in the same way ?

συ καλεις αυτα αρετην ομοιως ;

Men: Not at all , O Socrates .

Ου δηπου , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: But **vice** . (Αλλα κακιαν .)

Men: Entirely so without a doubt . (Παντως δηπου .)

Soc: Accordingly then , as it is reasonable , either **Righteousness** or **Soundmindedness** or **Piousness**

αρα , ως εοικε , δικαιοσυνην η σωφροσυνην η οσιοτητα or some other **Part** of **Virtue** , must accompany **This Provision** . But if **not** , it will **not** be **Virtue** ,

78E η τι αλλο μοριον αρετης , Δει προσειναι τουτω τω πορω : δε ει μη , εσται ουκ αρετη , even though it provides **Good** things .

καιπερ εκποριζουσα ταγαθα .

Men: For without these , how could it still be virtue ?

γαρ ανευ τουτων Πως αν γενοιτ αρετη ;

Soc: Then **The Non-Providing** of **gold** and **silver** ; **This Being-at-a-loss** , is also **Self Virtue** , when

δε Το μη εκποριζειν χρυσιον και αργυριον , η απορια εστιν και αυτη αρετη , οταν it is **not Just** to do so , **neither** for Self **nor** for another .

μη δικαιον η , μητε αυτω μητε αλλω ,

Men: It appears to be .

Φαινεται .

Soc: Therefore **The Way** of **Providing** , no more than **The Being-at-a-loss** of **these kinds** of **goods**

Αρα ο πορος Ουδεν μαλλον η η απορια των τοιουτων αγαθων

will be **Virtue** ; but as it is reasonable , on the one hand , that which comes to be with **Righteousness**
αν ειη αρετη , αλλα , ως εοικεν , μεν ο γιγμηται μετα δικαιοσυνης
will be **Virtue** , but on the other hand , that which comes to be without any of these **Real-Beings** , **vice** .
79A εσται αρετη , δ' ο αν ανευ παντων των τοιουτων , κακια .

Men: It appears to me that it must necessarily be as you say .

Δοκει μοι αναγκαιον ειναι ως λεγεις .

Soc: Is it not the case then , that we said a little while ago , that each one of these is a **Part** of **Virtue** ,
Ουκουν εφαμεν ολιγον προτερον εκαστον τουτων ειναι μοριον αρετης ,
such as **Righteousness** and **Soundmindedness** and **All Those** such as **These** ?

την δικαιοσυνην και σωφροσυνην και παντα τα τοιαυτα ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: In that case , O Meno , are you playing with me ?

Ειτα , ω Μενων , παιζεις προς με ;

Men: Why do you say that , O Socrates ?

Τι δη , ω Σωκρατες ;

Soc: Because even though I pleaded with thee just now not to break apart nor cut up **Virtue/Excellence** ,

Οτι εμου δεηθεντος σου αρτι μη καταγνυναι μηδε κερματιζειν την αρετην
and even though you were given **Models** , according to which you must answer , on the one hand ,
και δοντος παραδεγματα καθ' α δεοι αποκρινεσθαι , μεν
you failed to pay attention to this , and on the other hand , tell me , that virtue is *the ability to provide*
79B ημελησας τουτου , δε λεγεις μοι , οτι αρετη εστιον οιον τ' ποριζεσθαι
good things along with righteousness . Then do you say that *this* is a part of **Virtue** ?

ταγαθα μετα δικαιοσυνης : δε φης τουτο ειναι μοριον αρετης ;

Men: I do indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that it results from that which thou has agreed upon , that *this* is Virtue ;

Ουκουν συμβαινει εξ ων συ ομολογεις , το τουτο ειναι αρετην ,
to do whatever one does , with a Part of Virtue . For you say that Righteousness , and each of these
πραττειν ο τι αν πραττη , μετα μοριου αρετης ; γαρ φης την δικαιοσυνην και εκαστα τουτων
are a part of Virtue , Why then do I say that you are playing with me ? Because of my pleading to tell me
ειναι μοριον αρετης . τι ουν δη λεγω τουτο ; οτι εμου δεηθεντος ειπειν
about **The Whole** of **Virtue** , and so on the one hand , you are far from explaining what **Self** is , whereas

την ολον αρετην , μεν δεις πολλου ειπειν ο τι αυτην εστι ,
on the other hand , you say that *every act* is virtue , if indeed it is performed with a part of Virtue ; thus
79C δε φης πασαν πραξιν ειναι αρετην , εανπερ πραττηται μετα μοριου αρετης ,
answering just as if you had already acknowledged for me what **The Whole** of **Virtue** is , even when
ειρηκως ωσπερ και ηδη γνωσομενου εμου ο τι το ολον αρετη εστι , εαν και
you cut **Self** up into **Parts** . Therefore , as it appears to me , you must start again from the beginning ,
συ κατακερματιζης αυτην κατα μορια . ουν , ως δοκει εμοι , σοι δειται παλιν εξ αρχης ,
from the same question , O friend Meno , “What is Virtue?” , if every act performed along with a Part
της αυτης ερωτησεως , ω φιλε Μενων , τι εστιν αρετη , ει πασα πραξεις μετα μοριου
of Virtue , will be Virtue ? For this is what it means , when someone says , that every act performed
αρετης αν ειη αρετη ; γαρ τουτο εστι λεγειν , οταν τις λεγη , οτι πασα πραξεις
along with Righteousness is Virtue . Or does it appear to thee that there is no need to start again from the
μετα η δικαιοσυνης εστιν αρετη . η δοκει σοι ου δεισθαι παλιν της
same question , but do you think that anyone can know whatever Virtue is , when they do not know **Self** ?
αυτης ερωτησεως , αλλ' οiei τινα ειδεναι ο τι αρετης εστιν , μη ειδοτα αυτην ;

Men: It does not indeed so appear to me .

Ουκ δοκει εμοιγε .

Soc: For if you also remember , when I was just now answering you about **Shape** , we rejected **79D** γαρ Ει και μεμνησαι , οτ' εγω αρτι απεκριναμην σοι περι του σχηματος , απεβαλλομεν that kind of answer that attempts to explain something , by using terms that are still to be investigated την τοιαυτην αποκρισιν επιχειρουσαν αποκρινεσθαι που δια των ετι ζητουμενων and that have not yet been agreed upon .

και μηπω ωμολογημενων .

Men: And we indeed acted correctly in rejecting it , O Socrates .

Και γε ορθως απεβαλλομεν , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Now then . O noble friend , thou must not think , that while , “Whatever is **The Nature of Virtue** τοιουν , ω αριστε , συ Μη μηδε ο τι εστιν οιου αρετης as a **Whole**” , is still under investigation , that by answering in terms of The Parts of Virtue , that you will ολης ετι ζητουμενης δια αποκρινομενος των μοριων ταυτης make the **Nature of Self** clear to anyone , or make anything else clear by speaking in this same way ?

79e δηλω— αυτην —σειν οτωουν , η οτιουν αλλο λεγων τουτω τω αυτω τροπω , Thus we must start again from this same question , to explain anything which you mean of **The Being** αλλα δεησεσθαι παλιν της αυτης ερωτησεως λεγεις τινος α λεγεις οντος of **Virtue/Excellence** ? Or do I appear to thee to say nothing ?

αρετης : η δοκω σοι λεγειν ουδεν ;

Men: You indeed appear to me to have spoken correctly .

δοκεις Εμοιγε λεγειν ορθως .

Soc: Now then answer again from the start ; what does thou and thine companion claim **Virtue** to be ?

τοιουν Αποκριναι παλιν εξ αρχης : τι και συ και σου ο εταιρος φης αρετην ειναι ;

Men: O Socrates , on the one hand , even before I met thee , I heard that thine self was nothing other

80A Ω Σωκρατες , μεν και πριν εγωγε συγγενεσθαι σοι , ηκουον οτι συ αυτος ουδεν αλλο than puzzled and that you also make others puzzled ; and now , as thou indeed appear to me , you are also

η απορεις τε και ποιεις τους αλλους απορειν : και νυν , ως γε δοκεις μοι , γοη— bewitching and drugging and completely enchanting me , so that I have become filled-full of perplexity .

—τευεις με και φαρματτεις με και ατεχνως κατεπαδεις με , ωστε γεγονεναι μεστον αποριας : And if I am allowed to make a joke , you seem to me in both your appearance and in every other way

και ει δει και τι σκωπαι , δοκεις μοι τε το ειδος και ταλλα ταυτη to be so very much like the flat sting-ray of the sea , for self also , always makes anyone numb

ειναι παντελως ομοιοτατος τη πλατεια ναρκη τη θαλαττια , γαρ αυτη και αι ποιει τον ναρκαν who comes near it and touches it , as thou now also appear to have benumbed me in such a way .

πλησιαζοντα και απομενον , συ νυν και δοκεις πεποιηκεναι ναρκαν εμε τοιουτον τι .

For truly , both my soul and my mouth are numb , and I do not know in what way to answer thee .

80B γαρ αληθως και την ψυχην και το στομα ναρκω , και εγωγε ουκ εχω ο τι αποκρινωμαι σοι . Even though I have indeed spoken countless times and made very many speeches in front of many ,

καιτοι γε ειρηκα μυριακις και παμπολλους λογους προς πολλους , and very good speeches about virtue , as they indeed appear to myself . But now , I cannot in any way και πανυ ευ περι αρετης , ως γε εδοκουν εμαυτω : δε νυν εχω ουδ' το παρα— at all say what it is . And you appear to me to be well advised not to travel abroad nor away from your

—παν ειπειν ο τι εστι . και δοκεις μοι ευ βουλευεσθαι ουκ εκπλεων ουδ' απο— home town , for if you did such things as a stranger in another city , you would be quickly driven away —δημων : γαρ ει ποιεις τοιαυτα ξενος εν αλλη πολει , αν ταχ' απαχθειης as a sorcerer .

ως γοης .

Soc: You are a villain , O Meno , and you almost deceived me .

ει Πανουργος , ω Μενων , και ιλιγου εξηπατησας με .

Men: Why exactly , O Socrates ? (Τι μαλιστα , ω Σωκρατες .)

Soc: I recognize that for the sake of which , you made a comparison about me .

80C Γιγνωσκω ου ενεκα εικασας με .

Men: Why then do you think so ? (Τινος δη οiei ;)

Soc: In order that I might make a comparison about thee in turn . For I know this about all those that
Ινα αντεικασω σε . δε εγω οida τουτο περι παντων των
are beautiful ; that they rejoice in these comparisons . For they are to their advantage ; for I also believe ,
καλων , οti χαιρουσιν εικαζομενοι . γαρ αυτοις λυσιτελει : γαρ , και οimai ,
that **Comparisons/Similes/Likenesses** of **The Beautiful** are **Beautiful** . Thus , I will **not** make one of thee .
αι εικονες των καλων καλαι . αλλ' ουκ αντεικασομαι σε .

But on the one hand , as far as I am concerned , if the sting-ray is self benumbing and thus it makes
δε μεν εγω , ει η ναρκη αυτη ναρκωσα και ουτω ποιει
the others numb , then I am like self , but if not on the other hand , then I am not . For I do not make the
τους αλλους ναρκαν , εοικα αυτη : ει μη δε , ου . γαρ ου ποιω τους
others puzzled from my self abundance , but by being all the more self puzzled , and in this way

80D αλλους απορειν αυτος ευποωρων , αλλα παντος μαλλον αυτος απορων και ουτως
I make the others puzzled . And now concerning **Virtue/Excellence** , what **It Is** , I on the one hand ,
ποιω τους αλλους απορειν . και νυν περι αρετης , ο εστιν , εγω μεν
do not know , then of course , perhaps you did know before , until you touched me ; however , now
ουκ οida , μεντοι ισως μεν ηδησθα προτερον πριν αψασθαι εμου , μεντοι νυν
you resemble , one who does not know . But nevertheless , on the other hand , I am willing to consider
ομοιος ει ουκ ειδοτι . ομως δε εθελω σκεψασθαι
and to search along with thee for *what in the world It Is* .

και συζητησαι μετα σου ο τι ποτε εστιν .

Men: And in what way will you search for this , O Socrates ;

Και τινα τροπον ζητησεις τουτο , ω Σωκρατες ,

(1) that which you do not know at all , whatever it is ?

ο μη οισθα το παραπαν ο τι εστι ;
For of the things of which you do not know, what kind will you assume it is for which you search ?
γαρ ων ουκ οισθα ποιον προθενενος ζητησεις ;

(2) Or , and that most especially , if you may happen upon self ,

η και οti μαλιστα ει εντυχοις αυτω ,
how will you ever know that this is , that which thou does not know ?
πως ειση οti τουτο εστιν , ο συ ουκ ηδησθα ;

Soc: I understand what it is that you intend to say , O Meno . Do you see that it is a contentious

80E Μανθαω οιον βουλει λεγειν , ω Μενων . ορας ως τουτον εριστικον
argument which you are presenting ? Since it claims that people in general ,
λογον καταγεις , αρα εστι ως ανθρωπω

(1) should neither search for that which they know ,

ουτε ζητειν ο οιδεν
(2) nor for that which they do not know ?

ουτε ο μη οιδεν ;
(3) For they should neither search for that which they indeed know , for they already know ,
γαρ αν ουτε ζητοι ο γε οιδε , γαρ οιδε ,
and there is indeed no need for this kind of search .

και γε ουδεν δει τω τοιουτω ζητησεως :

(4) Neither should they search for that which they do not know ;
ουτε ο μη οιδεν :

for they would not know what it is they are looking for .

γὰρ οὐδε οἶδεν ὅ τι ζητήσει .

Men: Does this argument not appear to thee to be well stated , O Socrates ?

81A Οὐκ οὐτος οὗτος ὁ λόγος δοκεῖ σοι καλῶς λεγέσθαι , ὦ Σωκράτης ;

Soc: Not as far as I am concerned .

Οὐκ ἐμοίγε .

Men: Can you explain in what way ?

Ἐχεις λέγειν ὅπη ;

Soc: I can indeed ! For I have heard from both Wise Men and Women about **The Divine Realities** . . .

Ἐγώγε : γὰρ ἀκηκοα τε σοφῶν ἀνδρῶν καὶ γυναικῶν περὶ τὰ θεῖα πράγματα—

Men: What logos did they speak about ?

Τίνα λόγον λεγοντῶν ;

Soc: About **The Truth** , as it appeared to me at least , and **Beauty** .

Ἀληθὴ , δοκεῖν ἐμοίγε , καὶ καλὸν .

Men: What was this , and who were the speakers ?

Τίνα τοῦτον , καὶ τινες οἱ λεγοντες ;

Soc: On the one hand , the speakers were **Priests** and **Priestesses** , who have paid careful attention so as
μεν Οἱ λεγοντες εἰσι τῶν ἱερῶν τε καὶ ἱερειῶν μεμεληκε τ'

to be able to deliver **The Logos Pertaining to Their Ministry** . And **Pindar** , on the other hand , and
εἶναι οἰοῖς δίδοναι λόγον περὶ ὧν μεταχειρίζονται : καὶ Πινδαρος δὲ καὶ
many **Others** who are **Divine Poets** speak . This then , is that which they say ; but

81B πολλοὶ ἄλλοι ὅσοι εἰσιν θεοὶ τῶν ποιητῶν λέγει , ταῦτι δὲ ἐστὶν ἅ λέγουσι : ἀλλὰ
consider , if they appear to you to speak **The Truth** . For they say that **the soul** of a human being is
σκοπεῖ , εἰ δοκοῦσιν σοι λέγειν ἀληθὴ . γὰρ φασὶ τὴν ψυχὴν τοῦ ἀνθρώπου εἶναι
Immortal/Deathless , and at one time it comes to an end , which they surely say is to die , but at another
ἀθάνατον , καὶ μὲν τότε τελευτᾷ ὁ δὲ καλοῦσι ἀποθνήσκειν , δὲ
time **she** comes to be again , whereas **she** is never completely annihilated . Surely then on account of
τότε , γίγνεσθαι πάλιν , δ' οὐδεποτε ἀπολλύσθαι : δὴ δια
these concerns , one should live one's life with the utmost **Piety** . For which reason :

ταῦτα ἂν δεῖν διαβίωναι τὸν βίον ὥς ὀσιωτάτα : γὰρ οἱσι —

"In **The Ninth Year** , **Persephone** sends **souls** ,

ἐνατῷ ἐτεί Φερσεφὸνα ἀνδίδοι ψυχὰς

of **those** from whom **She** has received the penalty for ancient grief

κείνων δέξεται ποινὰν παλαιοῦ πένθεος

back again to **The Sun Above** ,

πάλιν εἰς τὸν αἰὸν ὑπερθεῖν

from **these** arise **Those** that would be **Noble Kings** and **Great** men who are **Strong** and **Agile**

81C ἐκ τὰν ἀγαθοὶ βασιλεῖς καὶ μεγιστοὶ ἄνδρες κραιπνοὶ σθένει

and **Those** who are surpassing in **Wisdom** ,

τε αὐξοντ' σοφία .

who are then called **Holy Heroes** among human beings in the ages to come ."

ἐς δὲ καλεῦνται ἀγνοὶ ἥρωες πρὸς ἀνθρώπων τὸν χρόνον λοιπὸν .

Therefore , inasmuch as **the soul** is **Immortal** , **she** has been born many times , and so **she** has seen
οὐν Ἄτε ἡ ψυχὴ οὐσα ἀθάνατος γεγонуῖα πολλακὶς τε καὶ εὐρακῦα
both **All things here** and **Those in Hades/Invisible** , there is **nothing** which **she** has not learned ; so that
καὶ τὰ πάντα χρήματα ἐνθάδε καὶ τὰ ἐν Αἴδου , ἐστὶν οὐκ τι ὅ οὐ μεμαθηκέν : ὥστε

it is not at all surprising that **she** is able to **Remember** , whatever indeed **she** knew before , both about ουδεν θαυμαστον αυτην ειναι οιον τε αναμνησθηναι , α και γε ηπιστατο προτερον , και περι **Virtue** and about **Other Beings** . For inasmuch as by **The Whole** of **Nature Being Akin** , and since **81D** αρετης και περι αλλων . γαρ ατε της απασης φυσεως ουσης συγγενους , και **the soul** has learned **Everything** , **nothing** prevents us by **Remembering only One** -surely then I mean της ψυχης μεμαθηκυιας απαντα , ουδεν κωλυει αναμνησθεντα μονον εν , δη **That which** human beings call **Learning** -to **Recover Everything else** from **Self** , if one is **Virile**

ο ανθρωποι καλουσιν μαθησιν , ανευρειν παντα ταλλα αυτον , εαν τις η ανδρειος and **does not tire** of **Searching** ; for accordingly **The Whole** of **Searching** and **Learning** is **Recollection** . και μη αποκαμνη ζητων : γαρ αρα το ολον το ζητειν και το μανθανειν εστιν αναμνησις . Then one must not be persuaded by that contentious argument ; for on the one hand , it will make us **idle** , ουκουν δει πειθεσθαι τουτω τω εριστικω λογω : γαρ μεν ουτος αν ποιησειε ημας αργους and it is **pleasant** to hear for those people that are **faint-hearted** , whereas on the other hand , the following και εστι ηδυσ ακουσαι των ανθρωπων τοις μαλακοις , δε οδε **Logos** makes people **Energetic** and **Inquisitive** ; which **Logos** , I continue Trusting that **It Is True** , **81E** ποιει εργαστικους τε και ζητητικους : ω εγω πιστευων ειναι Αληθει and so I wish to **Enquire** along with thee into **whatever Virtue/Excellence Is** .

εθελω ζητειν μετα σου οτι αρετη εστιν .
Men: Yes, O Socrates ; but in what way do you mean this , that we do not learn , but that which Ναι , ω Σωκρατες : αλλα πως λεγεις τουτο , οτι ου μανθανομεν , αλλα ην we call learning is recollection ? Can you teach me , in what way that this has to be ? καλουμεν μαθησιν εστιν αναμνησις ; εχεις διδασθαι με ουτως ως τουτο εχει ;

Soc: And as I was saying just now , O Meno , you are a villain , since now you also ask if I can Και ειπον αρτι , ω Μενων , ει πανουργος οτι νυν και ερωτας ει εχω teach you , when I say that there is no teaching but **Recollection** , in order that self may then διδασθαι σε , ος φημι ειναι ου διδασξην αλλ' αναμνησιν , ινα αυτος δη immediately show me up , as contradicting myself .

82A ευθυς φαινωμαι ταναντια λεγων εμαυτω .

Men: No by Zeus , O Socrates , I meant no harm by this , but I only spoke out of habit .

Ου μα τον Δια , ω Σωκρατες , ειπον ου βλεψας προς τουτο , αλλ' υπο του εθους : But if you can somehow demonstrate to me , that it has to be just as you say , then show me . αλλ' ει εχεις πως ενδειξασθαι μοι , οτι εχει ωσπερ λεγεις , ενδειξαι .

Soc: But on the one hand , it is no easy matter , but nevertheless I want to make the effort

Αλλ' μεν εστι ου ραδιον , δε ομως εθελω προθυμηθηναι for thine sake . Then summon for me one , among those of your many attendants , σου ενεκα . αλλα προσκαλεσον μοι ενα των τουτωνι σαυτου των πολλων ακολουθων , whosoever you wish , in order that I can demonstrate this process to thee , in this attendant .

82B οντινα βουλει , ινα επιδειξωμαι σοι εν τουτω .

Men: Most certainly . Come here .

Πανυ γε . προσελθε δευρο .

Soc: First of all is he a Hellene , and does he speak the Hellenic language ?

μεν εστι Ελλην και ελληννιζει ;

Men: Very much so indeed ! He was indeed born in my home !

Πανυ σφοδρα γε , γε οικογενης .

Soc: Then **offer up your mind** , to whether it seems to you if he is remembering or being taught by me .

δη Προσεχε τον νουν , οποπερ αν φαινεται σοι η αναμιμνησκομενος η μανθανων παρ εμου .

Men: Then I will do so .

Αλλα προσεξω .

The Demonstration of Recollection

Soc: (Drawing on the ground) Then tell me , O Son , do you recognize that a space like this is a **square** ?
 δη Ειπε μοι , ω παι , γινωσκεις οτι χωριον τοιουτον εστιν τετραγωνον ;

Boy: I do indeed . (Εγωγε.)

Soc: Therefore , is a **square** space , that which has these **four lines** that are **all Equal** ?

82C ουν Εστιν τετραγωνον χωριον εχον ταυτας τετταρας τας γραμμας ουσας πασας ισας ;

Boy: Quite so indeed . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Are not these lines that **it** has **through the middle** also **Equal** ?

εστιν Ου ταυτασι τας εχον δια μεσου και ισας ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that such a space may be both larger and smaller ;

Ουκουν τοιουτον χωριον αν ειη και μειζον και ελαττον ;

Boy: Quite so indeed . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Therefore , if this side were **two** feet , and this one **two** feet , how many feet will the whole be ?

ουν Ει αυτη η πλευρα δυοιν ποδων και αυτη δυοιν , ποσων ποδων αν το ολον ειη ;

Consider it in this way then ; if this side was **two** feet , but this side was only **one** foot ,

σκοπει ωδε δε : ει ταυτη ην δυοιν ποδων , δε ταυτη μονον ενος ποδος ,

this other space would be **once two** feet ?

το αλλο τι χωριον αν ην απαξ δυοιν ποδων ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then since this side and the other side are **two** feet ,

82D δε Επειδη και ταυτη δυοιν ποδων ,

does this other space become **twice two** feet ?

η αλλο τι γινεται δις δυοιν ;

Boy: It becomes . (Γινεται .)

Soc: Accordingly then , it becomes **twice two** feet ?

αρα γινεται δις Δυοιν ποδων ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Therefore , how many are **twice** the **two** feet ? Count and tell me .

ουν Ποσοι εισιν δις οι δου ποδες ; λογισαμενος ειπε .

Boy: **Four** , O Socrates .

Τετταρες , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Then could there not be another space that is **Double** the size of **this one** ?

Ουκουν αν γενοιτ' ετερον του χωριου διπλασιον τουτου ,

Then could such a space , have all of the lines **Equal** , just like **this one** ?

δε τοιουτον , εχον πασας τας γραμμας ισας ωσπερ τουτο ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Therefore , of how many feet will it be ?

ουν Ποσων ποδων εσται ;

Boy: **Eight** . (Οκτω .)

Soc: Come along then , try to tell me how long each line of that space will be . For if on the one hand ,

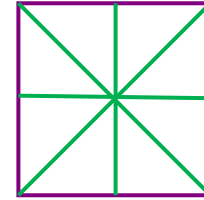
82E Φερε δη , πειρω ειπειν μοι τις πηλικη εκαστη η γραμμη εκεινου εσται . γαρ μεν

this line is **two** feet , then on the other hand , what will be the length of that which is **Double** ;

τουδε δυοιν ποδων : δε τι η εκεινου του διπλασιου ;

Boy: It is clear then , O Socrates , that it will be **Double** .

Δηλον δη , ω Σωκρατες , οτι διπλασια .



Once

1	2
3	4

Twice

Soc: Observe , O Meno , that I teach nothing to this boy , but that I ask everything ? And now

Ορας , ω Μενων , ως εγω διδασκε ουδεν τουτον , αλλ' ερωτω παντα ; και νυν he thinks that he knows , what kind of line it is from which **the eight foot space** will be formed . ουτος οιεται ειδεναι , οποια εστιν αφ' ης το οκτωπουν χωριον γηνεσεται : or does it not so appear to thee ?

η ου δοκει σοι ;

Men: It does indeed . (Εμοιγε .)

Soc: Does he know then ? (Οιδεν ουν ;)

Men: Certainly not ! (δητα Ου .)

Soc: But he does indeed think that it will be formed from the **Double** ?

δε γε Οιεται απο της διπλασιας ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Surely then observe as Self **Recollects** each step in order , as it must be **Remembered** . Then thou

δη Θεω αυτον αναμιμνησκομενον εφεξης , ως δει αναμιμνησκεσθαι . δε συ tell me , does thou say that the **double** space is formed from the **double** line? I mean a space like this ; **83A** λεγε μοι , φης το διπλασιον χωριον γηνεσθαι απο της διπλασιας γραμμης ? λεγω τοιονδε , not a space that has one side that is long , but another that is short , but that which is **Equal** in every way μη μεν ταυτη μακρον , δε τη βραχυ , αλλα εστω ισον πανταχη just like **this one** , but **Double** of **this one** , of **eight feet** . Then see , if it still appears to thee , that ωσπερ τουτι , δε διπλασιον τουτου , οκτωπουν : αλλ' ορα , ει ετι δοκει σοι **this space** will arise from **the line** which is **Doubled** .

εσεσθαι απο της διπλασιας .

Boy: It does indeed . (Εμοιγε .)

Soc: Then does not **this self** become **Doubled**

Ουκουν ταυτης αυτη γηνεται διπλασια , if we were to add **another such line here** ?

αν προσθωμεν ετεραν τοσαυτην ενθενδε ;

Boy: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Then from **that line** , you say ,

δη Απο ταυτης , φης , there will be **the eight foot space** ,

εσται το οκτωπουν χωριον ,

if there were **four** such lines ?

αν γενωνται τετταρες τοσαυται ?

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then , from **self** , let us draw **four Equal** lines .

83B δη απ' αυτης Αναγραφωμεθα τετταρας ισας .

Would this be nothing else than that which you say is **the eight foot space** ?

αν τουτι ειη αλλο τι η το ο φης ειναι οκτωπουν ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then are there not within **self** these **four** spaces ; each of which , is **Equal** to **this four foot space** ?

Ουκουν εν αυτω ταυτι τετταρα , εκαστον ων εστι ισον τουτι τω τεταρποδι ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Therefore , how large has it become ; Is it not **Four times such a space** ?

ουν Ποσον γηνεται ; ου τετρακις τοσουτον ;

Boy: How then , could it not be ? (Πως δ' ου ;)

Soc: Therefore , that which is **Four times** is **Double** ?

ουν το τοσουτον τετρακις εστι Διπλασιον ;

Once				
Twice				
Three X				
Four X				

Boy: No , by Zeus ! (Ου μα Δια .)

Soc: Then how much larger ?

Αλλα ποσαπλασιον ;

Boy: Four times as much .

Τετραπλασιον .

Soc: So then , O Son , from the line that is **Doubled** , not a **Double** , but a **Quadruple** space is formed .

83C αρα , ω παι , Απο της διπλασιας , ου διπλασιον αλλα τετραπλασιον χωριον γινεται .

Boy: What you say is true . (λεγεις Αληθη .)

Soc: Since **Four times four** is **sixteen** , is it not ?

γαρ τετρακις τετταρων εστιν εκκαιδεκα . ουχι ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then from what line does **the eight foot space** arise ? For it is *not* from **this Quadrupled** line .

δ' απο ποιας γραμμας Οκτωπουν ; μεν ουχι απο ταυτης τετραπλασιον ;

Boy: I say so . (Φημι.)

Soc: But **this four foot space** arises from **this half line** ?

δε τουτι Τετραπουν απο ταυτησι της ημισεας ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Very well . Thus on the one hand , **the eight foot space** does not arise

Ειεν : δε μεν το οκτωπουν ου

from this line that is **doubled** , nor on the other hand , from this line that is **half** of it .

τουδε εστι διπλασιον , δε τουτου ημισυ ;

Boy: Yes . < Ναι . >

Soc: Nor on the one hand , will it arise from a line greater than **this larger one**

Ουκ μεν εσται απο γραμμης μειζονος η τοσαυτης

nor on the other hand , will it arise from a line smaller than **this smaller one** , or do you not agree ?

83D δε απο ελαττονος η τοσησδι ; η ου ;

Boy: It does indeed appear to me in such a way .

Εμοιγε δοκει ουτως .

Soc: Well said . For you should answer that which appears to be the case for thee .

Καλως : γαρ αποκρινου το δοκουν τουτο σοι .

And now tell me , did we not already say that **this line** was of **two** feet , but **that one** of **four** ?

και λεγε μοι : ουχ ηδε μεν ην δυοιν ποδοιν , δε η τετταρων ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Accordingly then , the line of **the eight foot space** must be *larger than* **this two foot line** ,

αρα μεν την γραμμην του οκτωποδος χωριου Δει ειναι μειζω τηςδε διποδος της ,

but *less than* **this four foot line** .

δε ελαττω τετραποδος της .

Boy: It must be . (Δει.)

Soc: Then try to explain of what length you say self must be .

83E δη Πειρω λεγειν τινα πηλικην φης αυτην ειναι .

Boy: **Three** feet . (Τριποδα .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , that if we add **half of that** to **this line** , then it will be **three** feet ?

Ουκουν εανπερ προσληνομεθα ημισου το ταυτης , η τριπους ;

For **you know** that **this one** is **two** , but **this one** is **one** ; and in the same way , on the other side ,

γαρ **οιδε** μεν δυο , δε ο εις και ωσαυτως ενθενδε :

you know this one is **two** , but this one is **one** ; and this becomes the space of which you speak .

οιδε μεν δυο , δε ο εις : και τουτο γινεται το χωριον ο φης .

Boy: Yes . (Ναι.)

Soc: Is it not so , that if there are **three** feet this way , and **three** feet that way ,

Ουκουν αν η τριων τηδε και τριων τηδε ,
then the whole space becomes **Three times three** feet ?

το ολον χωριον γιγνεται τρις τριων ποδων ;

Boy: So it appears . (Φαινεται .)

Soc: Then , how much is **Three times three** feet ?

δε ποσοι εισι τρις Τρεις ποδες ;

Boy: **Nine** .

Εννεα .

Soc: But how many feet must **That Double** be ?

δε ποσων ποδων Εδει το διπλασιον ειναι ;

Boy: **Eight** .

Οκτω .

Soc: Accordingly then , **the eight foot space**

αρα το οκτωπουν χωριον

does not arise from the **three** foot line .

Ουδ' γιγνεται απο της τριποδος .

Boy: Certainly not . (δητα Ου .)

Soc: Then from what kind of line ? Try to tell us precisely .

84A Αλλ' απο ποιας ; πειρω ειπειν ημιν ακριβως :

And if you do not wish to use numbers , then show from what kind of line .

και ει μη βουλει αριθμειν , αλλα δειξον απο ποιας .

Boy: But by Zeus , O Socrates , **I certainly do not know** .

Αλλα μα τον Δια , ω Σωκρατες , εγωγε ουκ οίδα .

Soc: Do you in turn have in mind , O Meno , to which point he has already walked along **The Road**

αυ Εννοεις , ω Μενων , ου εστιν ηδη βαδιζων του οδε

of **Recollection** ? Since on the one hand , at first he did not **know** , any line from which **the eight foot**

αναμνησκεισθαι ; οτι μεν το μεν πρωτον ου ηδει , τις η γραμμη η του οκτωποδος

space arose , just as now he does not **know** yet , but then at that time he thought he **knew self** indeed , and

χωριου εστιν , ωσπερ νυν ουδε οιδεν πω , αλλ' ουν τοτε ωετο ειδεναι αυτην γ' , και

boldly answered as if he **knew** , and he was not led to think that he was at a loss . Whereas now , on the

θαρραλεως απεκρινετο ως ειδως , και ουχ ηγειτο απορειν : νυν

other hand , he has been led to think that he *is* at a loss , and just as he **does not know** , neither does

δε ηδη ηγειται απορειν , και ωσπερ ουκ οιδεν , ουδ'

he think that he **knows** .

84B οιεται ειδεναι .

Men: What you say is true . (λεγεις Αληθη .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that he has to be Better now , in regard to **that object** which he does not **know** ?

Ουκουν εχει βελτιον νυν περι το πραγμα ο ουκ ηδει ;

Men: This also appears to be so to me . (τουτο Και δοκει μοι .)

Soc: Therefore , by making him puzzled and numb just as the sting-ray does , have we done any harm ?

ουν ποιησαντες αυτον Απορειν και ναρκαν ωσπερ η ναρκη , μων τι εβλαψαμεν ;

Men: There does not appear to be , as far as I am concerned .

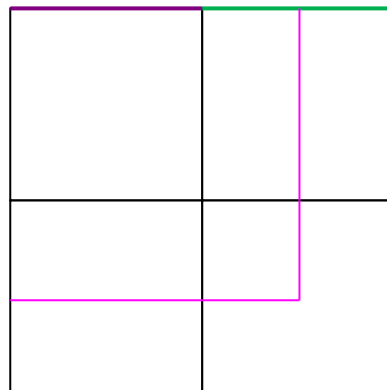
Ουκ δοκει εμοιγε .

Soc: Since we have indeed made him prepared in a certain way , as it is reasonable , in relation to

γουν πεποικαμεν Προυγου τι , ως εοικε , προς

in what way that which is to be discovered has to be . For now he will search and he will do it gladly ,

οπη το εξευρειν εχει : γαρ νυν ζητησειεν και αν μεν ηδεως



since he does not know , whereas at that time , he thought that he could go before large audiences , and
 ουκ ειδως , δε τοτε ωετ αν προς πολλους και
 on numerous occasions , and could speak well and with ease about the double space , as to how it must
 84C πολλακις και αν λεγειν ευ ραδιως περι του διπλασιου χωριου , ως δει
 arise from the line whose length is doubled .

εχειν την γραμμην μηκει διπλασιαν .

Men: Reasonably so . (Εοικεν.)

Soc: Therefore , do you think that he would have tried to seek or learn that which he thought he **knew**
 ουν Οιει αυτον αν επιχειρησαι ζητειν η μανθανειν τουτο , ο ωετο **ειδεναι**
 but did not **know** , before he fell into a puzzled state , and until he was led to think that he did not
 ουκ **ειδως** , προτερον κατεπεσεν εις αποριαν πριν ηγησαμενος μη
know , and then was longing to **know** ?

ειδεναι , και εποθησε το **ειδεναι** ;

Men: It does not appear so to me , O Socrates . (Ου δοκει μοι , ω Σωκρατες .)

Soc: Accordingly then , he has **Benefitted** by the numbing .

αρα Ωηντο (ονινημι) ναρκησας ;

Men: It appears so to me . (Δοκει μοι .)

Soc: Consider then , that arising from this puzzle , he will discover whatever he is searching for ,
 Σκεψαι δη εκ ταυτης της αποριας ανευρησει ο τι ζητων
 along with me , and I shall be doing nothing else than asking questions , nor will I be teaching him .
 μετ' εμου , και ουδεν αλλ' η ερωτωντος ου διδασκοντος :
 But be on guard to see if at some point you find me teaching and displaying to self , instead of
 84D δε φυλαττε αν που ευρης με διδασκοντα και διεξοντα αυτω , αλλα μη
 questioning him about his beliefs .

ανερωτωντα τουτου τας δοξας .

(To the boy) For you tell me ; is this not , on the one hand , our **four foot space** ? Do you understand ?

γαρ συ Λεγε μοι : εστι τουτο ου μεν ημιν το τετραπουν χωριον ; μανθανεις ;

Boy: I do indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Then can we add **this other one** that is **Equal** to **self** ?

δε αν προσθειμεν τουτι Ετερον ισον αυτω ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And **this third one** that is **Equal** to each of these ?

Και τοδε τριτον ισον εκαστερω τουτων ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so , that we can fill **this space in the corner/angle** ?

Ουκουν αν προσαναπληρωσαιμεθ' το τοδε εν τη γωνια ;

Boy: Entirely so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Then has this become any thing else than **four Equal** spaces ?

84E ουν ταδε γενοιτ' τι Αλλο αν τετταρα ισα χωρια ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: What next ? How many times more has **The Whole** become than **this (part)** ?

Τι ουν ; ποσαπλασιον τοδε το ολον γινεται τουδε ;

Boy: **Four times** . (Τετραπλασιον .)

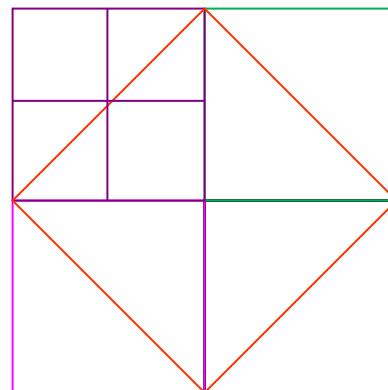
Soc: But we were required to generate the **double** ; or do you not remember

δε ημιν Εδει γενεσθαι διπλασιον : η ου μεμνησαι ;

Boy: I do very much indeed . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that **this very line** that extends from corner to corner ,

85A εστιν Ουκουν αυτηγραμμη τεινουσα εκ γωνιας εις γωνιαν ,



cuts each one of these (four) spaces in two ?

τεμνουσα εκαστον τουτων των χωριον διχα ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that **these four Equal lines** that are generated , enclose this space ?

Ουκουν αυται τετταρες ισαι γραμμαι γιγονται , περιεχουσαι τουτι χωριον ;

Boy: They are generated thus . (Γιγονται γαρ .)

Soc: Consider then ; how much/large is **this space** .

Σκοπει δη : τι πηλικον εστι τουτο το χωριον ;

Boy: I do not understand . (Ου μανθανω .)

Soc: Are there not **four** each , of **these inner lines** which have cut each of the spaces in **Half** ; or what ?
οντων Ουχι τετταρων εκαστη τουτων εντος η γραμμη αποτετμηκεν εκαστου ημισυ ; η ου ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Then how many **feet** are there in **this space** ?

δε Ποσα εν τωδε ;

Boy: **Four** . (Τετταρα .)

Soc: Therefore , how many feet has **this space** become ?

85B ουν ποσαπουν Τοδε γινεται ;

Boy: **Two** feet . (Δυο .)

Soc: Then what is the relation of **four** (The Whole) to **two** (the part) ?

δε τι εστιν Το τετταρα τοιν δυοιν ;

Boy: **Double** . (Διπλασια .)

Soc: Therefore , of how many feet has **this space** become ?

ουν ποσαπουν Τοδε γινεται ;

Boy: Of **Eight feet** . (Οκτωπουν .)

Soc: From which line ?

Απο ποιας γραμμης ;

Boy: **From this one** . (Απο ταυτης .)

Soc: From **the line** which extends from corner to corner , of the four foot spaces ?

Απο της τεινουσης εκ γωνιας εις γωνιαν του τετραποδος ;

Boy: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Thus , the wise indeed call this line **Diagonal** , so that if the name of this line is the **Diagonal** ,

δε οι σοφισται γε Καλουσι ταυτην διαμετρον : ωστ' ει ονομα ταυτη διαμετρος ,

then **the double space** , as you say (**82E**) , O Child of Meno , would arise from **The Diagonal** .

αν το διπλασιον χωριον , ως συ φης , ω παι Μενωνος , αν γιγνοιτ απο της διαμετρου .

Boy: Very much so , O Socrates .

Πανυ μεν ουν , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: In what way does it appear to thee , O Meno ? Was any opinion which he replied not of Self ?

Τι δοκει σοι , ω Μενων ; εστιν ηντινα δοξαν ουτος απεκρινατο ουχ αυτου ;

Men: No , but they were all of himself .

85C Ουκ , αλλ' εαυτου .

Soc: And yet he did indeed not **know** , as we said a short while ago ?

Και μην γε ουκ ηδει , ως εφαμεν ολιγον προτερον .

Men: What you say is true . (λεγεις Αληθη .)

Soc: But these opinions were indeed within Self , or what ?

δε αυται αι δοξαι γε Ενησαν αυτω : η ου ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Accordingly then , for one who does not **know** , concerning that which they do not **know** ,

αρα Τω ουκ ειδοτι περι ων μη ειδη

there still exist within them , **True Opinions** about those matters of which they did not **know** ?

ενεισιν αληθεις δοξαι περι τουτων ων ουκ **οιδεν** ;

Men: So it appears . (Φαινεται .)

Soc: So now on the one hand , **The Self Opinions** have just been awakened in **Self** just as if in a **Dream** ;

Και νυν μεν αι αυται δοξαι αρτι ανακεκινηται αυτω ωσπερ οναρ :

but if indeed on the other hand , someone will continue questioning **Self** about **These Selves** often

ει γε δε τις ανερησεται αυτον ταυτα τα αυτα πολλακις

and in many ways , you **know** that when **They** are brought to **Completion** , **Self** will **Know** about

και πολλαχι , **οισθ'** οτι τελευτων **επιστησεται** περι

These Selves no less accurately .

85D τουτων ουδενος ηττον ακριβως .

Men: That is likely . (Εοικεν .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that **Self** will **Know** , nothing by teaching , but by questioning ,

Ουκουν **επιστησεται** ουδενος διδασαντος αλλ' ερωτησαντος

Restoring The Self Knowledge that Arises from **Self** ?

αναλαβων **την αυτος επιστημην** εξ αυτου ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: But is not **That** which **Recovers Self Knowledge** within **Self** , **Recollection** ?

δε εστιν ουκ Το αναλαμβάνειν αυτον **επιστημην** εν αυτω αναμνησκεισθαι ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Take notice then , in regards to **The Knowledge** , which **That Self now** has ,

Αρ' ουν , ου **την επιστημην** , ην ουτος νυν εχει ,

it was either acquired at some time , or else **Self Always** Possessed **It** .

ητοι ελαβε ποτε η αι ειχεν

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that if on the one hand , **Self Always** Possessed **It** , **Self** was **Always Knowing** ;

Ουκουν ει μεν αι ειχεν , και ην αι **επιστημων** :

but if on the other hand , **Self** acquired **It** at some time , then indeed **It** could not have been acquired now

85E ει δε ελαβε ποτε , γε αν ουκ ειη ειληφως νυν

in this life , or has someone taught this boy geometry ? For this boy will **Do** the same with all geometrical

εν τω βιω η τις δεδιδαχε τουτον γεωμετρειν ; γαρ ουτος ποιησει ταυτα περι πασης γεω-

subjects , and also with all the other subjects of learning . Then , is there anyone who taught him all this ?

-μετριας και ταυτα απαντων των αλλων μαθηματων . ουν εστιν οστις δεδιδαχε παντα τουτον ;

For it is in some way just if you **know** , especially seeing that he was born and nurtured in thine home .

γαρ που δικαιος ει **ειδεναι** , αλλως επειδη γεγονε τε και τεθραπται εν τη ση οικια .

Men: But I do **know** indeed that **no one ever** taught him .

Αλλ' **οιδα** εγωγε οτι ουδεις πωποτε εδιδαξεν .

Soc: Then does he *possesses* **These Opinions** , or does he not ;

δε Εχει ταυτας τας δοξας , η ουχι ;

Men: It appears that he must , O Socrates .

φαινεται Αναγκη , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: But if he did not acquire them in this present life , is the following not already clear ;

86A δε Ει μη λαβων εν τω νυν βιω , τουτο ουκ ηδη δηλον ,

that he possessed them and learned them at some other time ?

οτι ειχε και εμεμαθηκει εν τινι αλλω χρονω ;

Men: So it appears . (Φαινεται .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that this must have been the time , that this boy was not a human-being ?

Ουκουν γε εστιν ο χρονος , οτ' ουτος ην ουκ ανθρωπος ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Therefore , if there existed within **Self True Opinions** , both at the time while being , and while not
οὐν Εἰ ἀν ἐνεσονται αὐτῷ ἀληθεῖς δοξαί τ' χρόνον ἀν ἡ οὐν καὶ ἡ μὴ
being a human-being , which **Opinions Awaken** to become **Knowledge** by questioning ; take notice then ,
οὐν ἀνθρώπος , αἱ ἐπεγερθεῖσαι γίνονται ἐπιστήμαι ἐρωτήσει , ἀρ' οὐν
will **the soul** of **Self** be disposed to **Learning/Remembering** for **All Time** ? For it is clear , that for **All**
ἡ ψυχὴ αὐτοῦ ἐστὶ μεμαθηκυῖα τὸν αἰὶ χρόνον ; γὰρ δηλὸν ὅτι τὸν πάντα
Time , **she** either is , or **she** is not a human-being ?

χρόνον ἐστὶν ἡ ἐστὶν οὐκ ἀνθρώπος .

Men: So it appears . (Φαίνεται .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that if **The Truth** of **The Real-Beings Always Exists** in our **Soul** , then **The Soul**

86B Οὐκοῦν εἰ ἡ ἀληθεῖα τῶν ὄντων αἰὶ ἐστὶν ἐν ἡμῖν τῇ ψυχῇ , ἡ ψυχὴ
will have to **Be Immortal** , so that you must take **Heart** , by attempting to **Search** and to **Recollect**
ἀν εἰ ἄθανατος , ὥστε χρὴ θάρρουντα , ἐπιχειρεῖν ζητεῖν καὶ ἀναμνησκεσθαι
that which you do not happen to **Know** at the present time , or rather this which you do not **Remember** .
ὃ μὴ τυγχάνεις ἐπιστάμενος νῦν , δ' τοῦτο ὃ ἐστὶν μὴ μεμνημένος ;

Men: You appear to me to speak well , O Socrates , although I do not **know** how .

δοκεῖς μοι λέγειν Εὐ , ὦ Σώκρατες , οὐκ οἶδ' ὅπως .

Soc: For so do I to myself , O Meno . And on the one hand , I would indeed not rely upon **The Logos**

γὰρ Καὶ ἐγὼ ἐμοὶ , ὦ Μένων . καὶ μὲν ἀν γέ οὐκ δισχυρίσαιμην ὑπὲρ τοῦ λόγου
in every other way , whereas on the other hand , I would contend in every way about the following ;
πάνυ τὰ ἄλλα : δ' ἀν διαμαχοίμην πάνυ περὶ τοῦτου ,

as far as I am able , in both **Word** and **Deed** ; that we will be **Better** and **More-Virile** and less **idle** ,

εἰ εἰην οἶος , τε καὶ λόγῳ καὶ ἐργῳ , ὅτι ἀν εἰμεν βελτίους καὶ ἀνδρικώτεροι καὶ ἡττον ἀργοὶ
if we think , that we must search , for that which one does not **know** , rather than thinking that it is not
εἰ οἰοίμεθα , δεῖν ζητεῖν , ἀ τίς μὴ οἶδε , ἡ οἰομένοι εἶναι μὴδε
possible to discover , that which we do not **Know** , nor must we search .

86C δυνατόν εὐρεῖν , ἀ μὴ ἐπιστάμεθα , μὴδε δεῖν ζητεῖν .

Men: And in this again , you appear to me to speak well , O Socrates .

Καὶ τοῦτο μὲν γέ δοκεῖς μοι λέγειν εὐ , ὦ Σώκρατες .

Soc: Therefore , inasmuch as we are of one mind , that one must search for that which one does not

οὐν ἐπειδὴ ὁμονοοῦμεν , ὅτι ζητητέον περὶ οὗ τίς μὴ
know , do you wish that we make an effort in common to **Search** into *what in the world* **Virtue** is ?
οἶδεν , Βούλει ἐπιχειρήσωμεν κοινῇ ζητεῖν τί ποτ' ἀρετὴ ἐστὶν ;

Men: Very much so . But I , O Socrates , would nevertheless be most pleased , both to consider and

Πάνυ μὲν οὐν . ἀλλ' ἐγώ γε , ὦ Σώκρατες , ἀν οὐ μέντοι ἡδίστα καὶ σκεψαίμην καὶ
to hear about that enquiry which I first mentioned , as to whether we must assume that **virtue** is truly
ἀκουσάιμι ἐκεῖνο ἡρόμην ὅπερ τὸ πρῶτον , ποτέρον δεῖ ἐπιχειρεῖν ὡς τῆς ἀρετῆς ὄντι
teachable , or whether **it** arises naturally , or in whatever way **it** arises in human-beings ?

86D διδασκῶ , ἡ ὡς παραγιγνομένης φύσει , ἡ ὡς τινὶ ποτὲ τρόπῳ αὐτῷ τοῖς ἀνθρώποις .

Soc: But if on the one hand , I was **The Ruler** not only of myself , O Meno , but also of thee , we would

Ἀλλ' εἰ μὲν ἐγὼ ἡρχόν μὴ μόνον ἐμαυτοῦ , ὦ Μένων , ἀλλὰ καὶ σου , ἀν
not have considered whether **Virtue** is teachable or not teachable , until we had first searched into
οὐκ ἂν προτέρων ἐσκεψάμεθα εἴτε ἡ ἀρετὴ διδασκτὸν εἴτε οὐ διδασκτὸν , πρὶν πρῶτον ἐζητησάιμεν
whatsoever **Self** is . But on the other hand , seeing that thou does not at first attempt to **Rule** Thyself ,
ὅ τι αὐτὸ ἐστὶν : δε ἐπειδὴ σὺ οὐδ' ἐμὲ ἐπιχειρεῖς ἀρχεῖν σαυτοῦ ,
surely then in order to be a “freeman” , but instead you try to rule me and you do rule , and I will yield
δη ἵνα ἡς ἐλευθερός , δε ἐπιχειρεῖς ἀρχεῖν ἐμοῦ τε ἀρχεῖς , καὶ συγχωρησομαι

to thee ; for what else can be done . Therefore we must consider , it appears , what the qualities are ,
86E σοι : γαρ τι χρη ποιεν ; ουν σκεπτεον εοικεν τι ποιον ειναι
of that which we do not yet **know** what it is . Therefore , if nothing else , will you loosen just a little
ο εστιν μηπω **ισμεν** ο τι εστιν . ουν ει μη γε χαλασον αλλα σμικρον
of your reign to me , and allow us to consider **Self** by way of a hypothesis , if either Self is teachable , or
της αρχης μοι , και συγχωρησον σκοπεισθαι αυτο εξ υποθεσεως , ειτε εστιν διδακτον ειτε
some other way . I mean by way of hypothesis in the following way ; just as the geometricians , often
οπωσουν . λεγω το εξ υποθεσεως ωδε , ωσπερ οι γεωμετραι πολλακις
consider , when selves are asked by someone if , “This triangular space can also be inscribed within
87A σκοπουνται επειδαν αυτους ερηται τις ει , το τοδε τριγωνον χωριον οιον τε ενταθηναι εις
this circle” , and one will reply that ; “I do not yet **know** whether this is so , but I think there has to be
τονδε τον κυκλον , τις αν ειποι οτι ουπω **οιδα** ει τουτο τοιουτον , αλλ’ οιμαι εχειν
a certain hypothesis , to prepare us , as it were , for the task at hand . If on the one hand , this (triangular)
μεν τινη υποθεσιν προυργου ωσπερ προς το πραγμα τοιανδε . ει μεν τουτο το
space is such as this ; that when it is applied to the given line , at that time it will **fall short** by a space
χωριον εστι οιον τοιουτον , αυτου παρατειναντα παρα την δοθεισαν γραμμην αν ελλειπειν χωριω

Proclus' Commentary On The First Book of Euclid's Elements

Proposition 44

To a given Straight line , to Apply in a given Rectilinear angle

Παρα την δοθεισαν ευθειαν παραβαλειν εν τη δοθειση ευθυγραμμιω γωνια

a Parallelogram Equal to a given Triangle .

παραλληλογραμμον ισον τω δοθεντι τριγωνω

On the one hand , Eudemus and his followers say that these : **The Application** of Areas/Spaces
419 μεν Ευδημον και τον οι περι φασιν η ταυτα παραβολη των χωριων
-their **Exceeding** and their **Falling short**- are Ancient Discoveries from The Muse of The Pythagoreans .
η υπερβολη τε και η ελλειψις Εστι αρχαια ευρηματα της μουσης των Πυθαγορειων .
Thus on the other hand , it is from the Pythagoreans that the more recent geometers took **These terms**
δε απο τουτων και οι νεωτεροι λαβοντες τα ονοματα
and transferred **Them** to the so-called conic lines , and of these , one is the Parabola ,
και μετηγαγον αυτα επι τας λεγομενας κωνικας γραμμας , και τουτων την μεν παραβολην ,
and another they called the **Hyperbola** , and another the **Ellipse** , although those Ancient and Divine
δε καλεσαντες την υπερβολην , δε την ελλειψιν , εκεινων των παλαιων και θειων
people saw the significance of **These terms** by their description in the drawing
ανδρων ορωντων τα σημαινομενα τουτων των ονοματων υπο ωρισμενην εν καταγραφη
of plane areas/spaces upon a finite straight line . For when the straight line is set out and you lay the
420 επιπεδω χωριων προς ευθειαν . γαρ οταν ευθειας εκκειμενης το
given area alongside the whole of the straight line , at that time , they say that you **Apply** that area ,
δοθεν χωριον συμπαρατεινης τη παση ευθεια , τοτε φασιν παραβαλλειν εκεινο το χωριον ,
but when you make the length of the area greater than the straight line itself , at that time it **Exceeds** ,
δε οταν ποιησης το μηκος του χωριου μειζον της ευθειας αυτης , τοτε υπερβαλλειν ,
but when the length is less , so that there is a part of the line extending beyond the area described , then
δε οταν ελασσον , ως ειναι τι της ευθειας εκτος του χωριου γραφεντος , τοτε
it **Falls short** .
ελλειπειν .

such as The Self that is being applied , appears to me that something else is the result , and in turn
 οιον η αυτο το παρατεταμενον , δοκει μοι ο τι αλλο συμβαινειν , και αυ
 if it is impossible for this to take place then something else follows . Therefore , based upon this
 ει εστι αδυνατον ταυτα παθειν αλλο : ουν συμβαινον το
 hypothesis I am willing to tell thee whether the inscription of the (triangular) space in the circle , is
87B υποθεμενος εθελω ειπειν σοι περι της εντασεως αυτου εις τον κυκλον
 either impossible or not .” Surely then , so also concerning **Virtue/Excellence** , since we do not **know**
 ειτε αδυνατον ειτε μη . δη ουτω και περι αρετης επειδη ημεις ουκ **ισμεν**
 neither what **It** is , nor what quality **It** has , let us consider by hypothesizing , whether **Self** is teachable
 ουθ’ ο τι εστιν ουθ’ τι οποιον , σκοπων υποθεμενοι ειτε αυτο εστιν διδακτον
 or not teachable , by reasoning in the following way : What if **Virtue** Exists among **The Real-Beings** of
 ειτε ου διδακτον , λεγοντες ωδε : τι ει αρετη εστι περι των οντων
The Soul , would **It** then be teachable or not teachable ? First of all , on the one hand , if **It** is
 την ψυχην , αν ειη διδακτον η ου διδακτον ; πρωτον μεν ει εστι
 of a kind other than **Knowledge** , will **It** then be *teachable* or not ? Or that which we were just saying ,
 οιον αλλοιον η επιστημη , αρα διδακτον η ου , η ο νυν δη ελεγομεν ,
Rememberable . Whereas on the other hand , it makes no difference to us *which name* we may use ,
 αναμνηστον : δε μηδεν διαφερετω ημιν οποτερω τω ονοματι αν χρωμεθα :
 but whether **It** is *teachable* ? Or is this clear to everyone indeed , that human beings are *taught*
87C αλλ’ αρα διδακτον ; η τουτο δηλον παντι γε , οτι ανθρωπος διδασκεται
 nothing else than **Knowledge** ?
 ουδεν αλλο η επιστημην ;

Men: It does indeed appear to be the case to me . (δοκει Εμοιγε .)

Soc: Then if **Virtue/Excellence** is indeed a certain kind of **Knowledge** ,
 δε ει η αρετη εστιν γ’ τις επιστημη ,
 then it is clear that **It** will be *teachable/Rememberable* .
 δηλον οτι αν ειη διδακτον .

Men: How could it not be ? (Πως γαρ ου ;) (For it did not *fall short* nor *long* but is **Right on Target** !)

Soc: Accordingly then , on the one hand , we are quickly free of this issue ,
 αρα μεν ταχυ απηλλαγμεθα Τουτου ,
 since if it is a kind of **Knowledge** then it is *teachable* , but if it is not so , then it is not teachable .
 οτι μεν οντος τοιουδε διδακτον , δ’ τοιουδε ου .

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Surely then , that which we must consider after this , as it is reasonable , is whether **Virtue**
 δη Το δει σκεψασθαι μετα τουτο , ως εοικεν , εστιν ποτερον η αρετη
 is **Knowledge** , or of a kind other than **Knowledge** ?
 επιστημη η αλλοιον επιστημης .

Men: This also appears to me indeed , that this must be considered next .

87D τουτο δοκει Εμοιγε τουτο ειναι σκεπτεον μετα .

Soc: What follows then ? Do we say that **Self Virtue/Excellence** is **Good** , or something else ,
 Τι δε δη ; φαμεν την αυτο αρετην ειναι αγαθον η τι αλλο ,
 and that the self hypothesis is maintained by us , that **Self** is **Good** ?
 και η αυτη υποθεσις μενει ημιν , αυτο ειναι αγαθον ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ μεν ουν .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that on the one hand , if *something* is **Good** that has also been *separated apart*
 Ουκουν μεν ει τι εστιν αγαθον και χωριζομενον αλλο
 from **Knowledge** , perhaps *it* may be that **Virtue** , *is not* a kind of **Knowledge** , but on the other hand ,
 επιστημης ταχ’ αν ειη η αρετη ουκ τις επιστημη : δε

if there is nothing **Good** , which is not **Contained** by **Knowledge** , then when we were suspecting that
ει μηδεν εστιν αγαθον , ο ουκ περιεχει επιστημη , αν υποπτευοντες
Self is a certain kind of **Knowledge** , we would be suspecting **Rightly** .
αυτο τιν' επιστημην ειναι υποτευοιμεν ορθως .

Men: It is so . (Εστι ταυτα .)

Soc: And certainly , it is by **Virtue/Excellence** indeed , that we are **Good** ?

Και μην αρετη γ' εσμεν αγαθοι ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And if **Good** , then **Beneficial/Useful** ; for *All* those that are **Good** are **Beneficial** , or not ?

87E Ει αγαθοι , δε ωφελιμοι , γαρ παντα αγαθα ωφελιμα . ουχι ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Surely then , **Virtue** is **Beneficial/Profitable/Advantageous/Useful** ?

δη η αρετη εστιν ωφελιμον ;

Men: Necessarily , from the conclusions we have agreed upon .

Αναγκη εκ των ωμολογημενων .

Soc: Surely then , let us consider that which is **Beneficial** for us , by taking up each

δη Σκεψομεθα α εστιν ωφελει ημας , αναλαμβανοντες καθ' εκαστον
Class/Kind/Species . Surely we say that **Health** , **Strength** , **Beauty** and **Wealth** and the likes of these ,
ποια . δη φαμεν , υγεια και ισχυς και καλλος και πλουτος και τα τοιαυτα ταυτα
are **Beneficial** , do we not ?

ωφελιμα , ουχι ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Whereas we say that *These Same Kinds* sometimes **also do harm** : or do you say otherwise or thus ?

88A δε φαμεν Ταυτα ταυτα ενιοτε και βλαπτειν : η συ φης αλλως η ουτως ;

Men: Not otherwise but in this way . (Ουκ , αλλ' ουτως .)

Soc: Consider then , when **Something Guides** each of *These* , **It Benefit** us , and when **something else**

Σκοπει δη , οταν τι ηγηται εκαστου τουτων , ωφελει ημας , και οταν τι
leads , **it does harm** ? Is it not then , on the one hand , when **The Correct Use Guides** , **It Benefits** us ,
, βλαπτει ; αρ' υχ μεν οταν ορθη χρησης , ωφελει ,
whereas on the other hand , when **It does not Guide** , **it harms** us ?

δε οταν μη , βλαπτει ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Now then furthermore , let us consider *those* belonging to **The Soul** . You call **Something**

τοιουν Ετι σκεψομεθα τα κατα την ψυχην . καλεις τι
Soundmindedness , and **Righteousness** and **Virility** and **Quickness-in-Learning** and **Memory**
σωφροσυνην και δικαιοσυνην και ανδρειαν και ευμαθιαν και μνημην
and **Magnificence** and *All Those* that are **Like These** .

και μεγαλοπρεπειαν και παντα τα τοιαυτα ;

Men: I do indeed . (Εγωγε .)

Soc: Consider then , of *Those* that appear to thee **not to Be Knowledge** , but **other** than **Knowledge** ,

88B Σκοπει δη , τουτων αττα δοκει σοι μη ειναι επιστημη αλλ' αλλο επιστημης ,
do **They** not at times **do harm** , but at other times **They Benefit** ? For example , if **virility** is **not Mindful**

ει ουχι τοτε μεν βλαπτει , τοτε δε ωφελει ; οιον , ει ανδρεια εστι μη φρονησις
then it is **not Virile** , but a kind of **rashness/audacity/confidence** , or is it not so that when a human-being
η ανδρεια αλλ' τι οιον θαρρος : μεν ουχ οταν ανθρωπος
is **rash** without **Intellect** , they are **harmed** , but when they act with **Intellect** , they are **Benefitted** ?

θαρρη ανευ νου , βλαπτεται , δε οταν συν νω , ωφελειται ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that the same holds true for both *Soundmindedness* and *Quickness-in-learning* ?

Ουκουν οσαυτως και σωφροσυνη και ευμαθια :
For also on the one hand , when *those* that are *Learned* and *Prepared* are coordinated with *Intellect* ,
και μεν μανθανομενα και καταρτυομενα μετα νου
they are *Beneficial* , whereas on the other hand , without *Intellect* *they* are *harmful* ?
ωφελιμα , δε ανευ νου βλαβερα ;

Men: Exceedingly much so . (Πανυ σφοδρα .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that generally on the one hand , when *The Soul* is *Guided by Mindfulness*

88C Ουκουν συλληβδην μεν της ψυχης ηγουμενης φρονησεως
Everything that *She Attempts* or *Endures Ends in Blessedness* ; whereas on the other hand , when *she*
παντα τα επιχειρηματα και καρτερηματα τελευτα εις ευδαιμονιαν , δ'
is lead by *mindlessness* , *everything she does* ends in *the opposite way* ?

αφροσυνης εις τουναντιον (κακαδαιμονιαν) ;

Men: That is likely . (Εοικεν)

Soc: Accordingly then , if *Excellence/Virtue* is a *Certain One* of *Those* in *The Soul* , and *It Is* also

αρα ει αρετη εστι τι των εν τη ψυχη ειναι και
Necessarily Beneficial to *Self* , then *Self* must be *Mindfulness* , seeing that *All The Selves* of *The Soul* ,
αναγκαιον ωφελιμω αυτω , αυτο δει ειναι φρονησιν , επειδηπερ παντα τα αυτα κατα την ψυχην
on the one hand , are *neither Beneficial* nor *harmful According to-Selves* , whereas on the other hand ,
μεν εστι ουτε ωφεριμα ουτε βλαβερα καθ' αυτα , δε
They become *Beneficial* or *harmful* by the addition of *Mindfulness* or *mindlessness* . Surely then ,
88D γινεται ωφελιμα τε και βλαβερα προσγενομενης φρονησεως η αφροσυνης . δη
according to *This Logos* , by *Excellence Being indeed Beneficial* , *It* must be a *Kind* of *Mindfulness* ?
κατα τουτον τον λογον την αρετην ουσαν γε ωφελιμον δει ειναι τιν' φρονησιν .

Men: So it appears to me indeed . (δοκει Εμοιγε .)

Soc: And surely then , let us also take up *The Other Kinds* , which we were just now discussing , such as

Και δη και ταλλα , α δη νυν ελεγομεν
Wealth and *Those Like These* , which are at times *Good* but at other times *harmful* . Were *They* not made
πλουτον τε και τα τοιαυτα , ειναι τοτε μεν αγαθα τοτε δε βλαβερα , αρ' ουχ εποiei
just like *The Other Kinds* of *the soul* , so that on the one hand , when *Mindfulness Guides They Benefit*
ωσπερ τη αλλη ψυχη μεν η φρονησις ηγουμενη τα ωφελιμα
The Soul , but on the other hand , when *mindlessness* leads *They harm the soul* . So also in turn
88E της ψυχης , δε αφροσυνη βλαβερα , ουτως και αυ
in these cases ; if on the one hand , *The Soul Uses* and *Guides Them Correctly* , then *She* makes *Selves*
τουτοις μεν η ψυχη χρωμενη και ηγουμενη ορθως ποιει αυτα
Beneficial , whereas on the other hand , if *she does not Use Them Correctly* , *she* makes *Them* *harmful* ?
ωφελιμα , δε μη ορθως βλαβερα ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Then indeed , *The Mindful Soul Guides Correctly* , whereas *the mindless soul misses The Mark* ?

δε γε η εμφρων ηγεται Ορθως , δ η αφρων ημαρτημενως ;

Men: This so . (ταυτα Εστι .)

Soc: Surely then do we not say that it is in this way in every case ; so that for human-beings , on the

δη Ουκουν ειπειν εστι ουτω κατα παντων , τω ανθρωπω
one hand , everything depends upon *the soul* , whereas on the other hand , *The Virtues* of *The Soul*
μεν παντα τα αλλα ανηρτησθαι εις την ψυχην , δε τα της ψυχης
Self depend upon *Mindfulness* , if *They* intend to be *Good* . And by *This Logos* , *That* which is
89A αυτης εις φρονησιν , ει μελλει ειναι αγαθα : και τω τουτω λογω το

Beneficial will be **Mindfulness** . Then do we declare **Excellence/Virtue** to **Be Beneficial** ?

ωφελιμον αν ειη φρονησις : δε φαμεν την αρετην ειναι ωφελιμον ;

Men: Very much so .(Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Accordingly then , do we declare **Excellence/Virtue** to **Be** ,

αρα φαμεν αρετην ειναι ,
either **Wholly** or a **Certain Part** of **Mindfulness** ?

ητοι συμπασαν η τι μερος Φρονησιν ;

Men: It appears to me , O Socrates , that the words spoken , are well spoken .

Δοκει μοι , ω Σωκρατες , τα λεγομενα , καλως λεγεσθαι .

Soc: Is it not so then , that if this has to be in this way , then human beings **cannot** be **Good** by **Nature** .

Ουκουν ει ταυτα εχει ουτως , οι αν ουκ ειεν αγαθοι φυσει .

Men: It does not appear so to me . (Ου δοκει μοι .)

Soc: For if that was possible , then this would also follow . If human beings were to become **Good** by

89B γαρ αν ην που και τοδ' : ει οι εγιγνοντο αγαθοι
Nature, then there would be **Some** of us who would **Recognize Those** of the young who are **Good** by
φυσει , αν ησαν που ημιν οι εγιγνωσκον τας των νεων τους αγαθους
Nature, and we would **Guard Those** whom **they** pointed-out to us by **Placing Them** in **The Upper-City**,
φυσεις , αν εφυλαττομεν εκεινων ους αποφηναντων ημεις παραλαβοντες εν ακροπολει ,
by **Sealing Them** up *even much more Securely* than we seal up our gold , in order that no one **ruins**
κατασημνησαμενοι πολυ μαλλον η το χρυσιον , ινα μηδεις διεφθειρεν
Selves ; then when **They** should arrive at **Their Prime** , **They** would become **Useful** to **Their City** .
αυτους , αλλ' επειδη αφικοιντα εις την ηλικιαν , γιγνοιντο χρησιμοι ταις πολεσιν .

Men: That is very likely , O Socrates .

τοι γε Εικος , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Take notice then , seeing that it is **not** by **Nature** that **The Good** come to **Be Good** ,

89C Αρ' ουν επειδη ου φυσει οι αγαθοι γιγνονται αγαθοι ,
then do **They** come to **Be Good** by **Learning/Remembering** ?

αρα μαθησει ;

Men: It already appears to me to be necessary , O Socrates , and it is clear according to the hypothesis ,

ηδη Δοκει μοι ειναι αναγκαιον , ω Σωκρατες , και δηλον κατα την υποθεσιν ,
that if indeed **Virtue/Excellence** is **Knowledge** , then it is **Teachable/Learnable/Rememberable** .

οτι ειπερ αρετη εστιν επιστημη , εστιν διδακτον .

Soc: Perhaps **It Is** by **Zeus** . But perhaps we did **not** speak **Correctly** by agreeing to this ?

Ισως νη Δια : αλλα μη ου καλως ωμολογησαμεν τουτο ;

Men: And it most certainly did appear just now that we spoke correctly .

Και γε μην εδοκει αρτι λεγεσθαι καλως .

Soc: But **Self** must not only just now appear to be spoken **Correctly** , but both in the present time

Αλλα αυτο μη δεη ουκ μονον αρτι δοkein λεγεσθαι καλως , αλλα και εν τω νυν
and in the time to come , if there is going to be anything **Sound/Healthy** about **Self** .

και εν τω επειτα , ει μελλει ειναι τι υγιες αυτου .

Men: What now then ? What are you seeing that makes self disagreeable and makes you distrust

89D Τι δη ουν ; τι βλεπων προς αυτο δυσχεραινεις και μη απιστεις
that **Virtue** is **not Knowledge** ?

η αρετη η ουκ επιστημη ;

Soc: I will tell thee , O Meno . For on the one hand , I **do not** withdraw that it is **Correctly** spoken ;

Εγω ερω σοι , ω Μενων . γαρ μεν , μη ουκ ανατιθεμαι το καλως λεγεσθαι
that if indeed **It is Knowledge** , then **It is Teachable/Rememberable** , whereas on the other hand ,
οτι ειπερ εστιν επιστημη αυτο ειναι διδακτον , δ'

consider whether it is reasonable to thee that I appear to distrust that **It** is **not Knowledge** . For tell me σκεψαι εαν εικοτως σοι δοκω απιστειν οτι εστιν ουκ επιστημη . γαρ ειπε μοι this ; if in the case **not only** of **Virtue** , but of **anything at all** that is **Teachable** , is it not necessary that τοδε : ει μη μονον αρετη πραγμα οτιουν εστι διδακτον , ουκ αναγκαιον there be both **those who teach** and **those who learn** of **Self** ?

ειναι και διδασκαλους και μαθητας αυτου ;

Men: It appears to me indeed . (δοκει Εμοιγε .)

Soc: Is it not so in turn , that the opposite must be the case ? For we would likely infer **Correctly** ,

89E Ουκουν αυ τουναντιον εικαζοιμεν καλως by inferring that **Self** is **not Teachable** , of which , there are neither **teachers** nor **learners** ,

εικαζοντες αυτο ειναι μη διδακτον ου μητε διδασκαλοι μητε μαθηται ;
(Both **Protagoras** and **Gorgias** the teacher of Meno were both self-professed “teachers of virtue”)

Men: This is so ; but does it appear to thee that there are no teachers of virtue ?

ταυτα Εστι : αλλ’ δοκουσι σοι ειναι ου διδασκαλοι αρετης ;

Soc: I am constantly searching , to see if there might be some teachers of **Self** , and even though

Πολλακις ζητων , ει ειεν τινες διδασκαλοι αυτης , γουν I am doing everything I can , I am not able to find any ; and yet I indeed share this search with many , ποιων παντα ου δυναμαι ευρειν . καιτοι γε ζητω μετα πολλων , and especially of those , whom I think would be the most experienced of **This Reality** .

και μαλιστα τουτων , ους οιωμαι αν ειναι εμπειροτατους του πραγαματος .

And just now , O Meno , **Anytos** has opportunely come to sit down here by us , with whom

90A και δη νυν , ω Μενων , Αυτος και καλον προκαθεζετο εις οδε ημιν , ω we must share this search . Thus it will be reasonable that we should share it . For in the first place , μεταδωμεν της ζητησεως . δ’ αν εικοτως μεταδοιμεν : γαρ μεν πρωτον Anytos here , is the son of a wealthy and wise father , **Anthemion** , who did not become wealthy by Αυτος οδε εστι πλουσιου τε και σοφου πατρος Ανθεμιωνος , ος ουκ εγενετο πλουσιος accident/spontaneously nor from a gift , just as **Ismenias** the Theban , by having only recently acquired του αυτοματος ουδε απο τινος δοντος , ωσπερ Ισμηνιας ο Θηβαιος ο νυν νεωστι ειληφως the fortune of **Polykrates** , since he acquired it by the wisdom and management of self . Then secondly , τα χρηματα Πολουκρατους , αλλα κτησαμενος τη σοφια και επιμελεια αυτου , και επεिता in respect to his other qualities , he is a citizen who is reputed to be **neither arrogant , nor pretentious** ,

τα αλλα πολιτης δοκων ειναι ουχ υπερηφανος ουδε ογκωδης **nor overbearing** , but a **Well-ordered** and **Able** man . Then in the third place , he raised Anytos well and

90B τε και επαχθης , αλλα κοσμιους και ευσταλης ανηρ : επεिता εθρεψε τουτον ευ και educated him , just as it appears to the majority of the Athenians , for they indeed elected self to their επαιδευσεν , ας δοκει τω πληθει Αθηναιων ; γουν αιρουνται αυτον επι τας highest offices . Surely then , along with such as these people , it is **Just** to search for teachers of **Virtue** , μεγιστας αρχας . δη μετα τοιουτων δικαιον ζητειν περι διδασκαλους αρετης , whether there are any or not , and who they might be .

ειτ’ εισιν ειτε μη , και οτινες .

Therefore , O Anytos , you must share in our search , with me and your guest-friend here , Meno , ουν , ω Αυτε , συ συζητησον ημιν , εμοι τε και σαυτου ξενω τωδε Μενωνι , who may the teachers be of this **Reality** ? Then consider it in this way . If we wish that Meno here , τινες αν διδασκαλοι ειεν περι τουτου του πραγαματος . δε σκεψαι ωδε : ει βουλομεθα Μενωνα τονδε to become a **good doctor** , to which **teachers** should we send self ?

90C γενεσθαι αγαθον ιαρτον , παρα τινας διδασκαλους αν πεμποιμεν αυτον ;

Should we not send him to the **doctors** ?

αρ’ ου παρα τους ιατροους ;

Anytos: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: What then if we wanted him to become a **good shoemaker** ,

Τι δ' ει βουλοιμεθα γενεσθαι αγαθον σκυτοτομον ,
would we not send him to the **shoemakers** ?

αρ' ου παρα τους σκυτοτομους ;

Any: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And in the same way for **the others** ?

Και ουτως ταλλα ;

Any: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Surely then tell me again about these same matters in the following way . We say that by sending

δη ειπε μοι παλιν περι των αυτων Ωδε . φαμεν πεμποντες
him to **doctors** that we would be acting **Rightly** , since we wish him to become a **doctor** . But whenever
τονδε παρα τους ιατροους αν επεμπομεν καλως , βουλομενοι γενεσθαι ιατρον : οταν
we say this , do we mean the following ; that we would be of **Sound-Mind** by sending self to those ,
90D λεγωμεν τουτο , αρ' λεγομεν τοδε , οτι αν σωφρονοιμεν πεμποντες αυτον παρα τους ,
who lay-claim/profess **The Art** rather than to those who do not , and to those who exact a fee for
τους αντιποιουμενους της τεχνης μαλλον η τους μη , τε και τους πραττομενους μισθον επ'
This Self , by offering themselves as **teachers** to those who wish to come and learn ?

τουτω αυτω , αποφηναντες αυτους διδασκαλους του βουλομενου ιεναι τε και μανθανειν ;

Is it not with a view towards these matters that we would act **rightly** to send him ?

αρ' ου βλεψαντες προς ταυτα αν καλως πεμποιμεν ;

Any: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Concerning **flute-playing** and all the other **Arts** ; is it not also very **foolish** , on the one hand ,

περι αυλησεως και των αλλων τα αυτα ταυτα ; εστι Ουκουν και πολλη ανοια μεν
for those who want to make someone a **flute-player** , **not** to intend to send him to **those** who profess
90E βουλομενους ποιησαι τινα αυλητην μη εθελειν πεμπειν παρα τους υπισχνουμενους
to **teach** the **Art** and who exact a fee , but on the other hand , to trouble *others* by seeking to learn certain
διδαξειν την τεχνην και πραττομενους μισθον , δε παρεχειν αλλοις ζητουντα μανθανειν τισι
subjects from those people , *who neither pretend* to be **teachers** nor is there a single **student**
πραγματα παρα τουτων , οι μητε προσποιουνται ειναι διδασκαλοι μητ' εστιν μηδεις μαθητης
of this learning of selves , which we expect the one whom we sent , to learn from selves !
του τουτου μαθηματος αυτων , ο ημεις αξιουμεν ον αν πεμπωμεν μανθανειν παρ' αυτων .
Does this not appear to you to be very **irrational** ?

ου δοκει σοι ειναι πολλη αλογια ;

Any: Yes, by **Zeus** it does to me indeed , and uneducated indeed besides .

Ναι μα Δια εμοιγε , και αμαθια γε προς .

Soc: Well said . Now then , thou can now assist in common along with me to advise your Guest-friend

91A Καλως λεγεις . τοινυν σε νυν εξεστι κοινη μετ' εμου βουλευεσθαι του ξενου
Meno concerning this . For he , O Anytos , has been telling me for some time , that he desires that kind
Μενωνος περι τουτουι . γαρ ουτος , ω Ανυτε , λεγει με προς παλαι , οτι επιθυμει ταυτης
of **Wisdom** and **Virtue** , by which human beings **Rightly Set-in-order** their home and their city , and
της σοφιας και αρετης , η οι ανθρωποι καλως διοικουσι τας οικιας και τας πολεις , και
take care of their own parents , and to **know** when to receive and when to send away both
τους θεραπουουσι αυτων τους γονεας , και **επιστανται** υποδεξασθαι τε και αποπεμψαι και
citizens and foreigners , in a way that **befits** a **good** man . Then consider , to whom should we send
91B πολιτας και ξενους αξιως αγαθου ανδρος . ουν σκοπει παρα τινας αν πεμποιμεν
him , that he may learn this **Virtue** ? Or is it clear from the account we just made , that we should
αυτον <μαθησομενον> ταυτην την αρετην . η δηλον κατα τον λογον δη αρτι , οτι

rightly send him , to those who profess to be **teachers** of **Virtue/Excellence** , and who offer
ορθως πεμπομεν , παρα τους τους υπισχνουμενος ειναι διδασκαλους αρετης και αποφηναντες
themselves publically to **All** the Hellenes who wish to learn , by fixing and exacting
αυτους κοινους των Ελληνων τω βουλομενω μανθανειν , ταξαμενους τε και πραττομενους
a fee for this ?

μισθον τουτου ;

Any: And who are those that you are referring to , O Socrates ?

Και τινας τουτους λεγεις , ω Σωκρατες ;

Soc: You do know without a doubt , that they are those who people call **sophists** .

συ Οισθα και δηπου , οτι ουτοι εισιν ους οι ανθρωποι καλουσι σοφιστας .

Any: By Heracles , hush , O Socrates ! May none of my family nor friends , nor

91C Ηρακλεις , ευφημει , ω Σωκρατες , μηδενα μητε των εμων οικειων μητε φιλων μητε
citizens nor foreign-guests , ever catch such insanity , so as to go to **these people** to be **mistreated** ,
αστον μητε ξενον , γ' λαβοι τοιαυτη μανια , ωστε ελθοντα παρα τουτους λωβηθηναι ,
since **they** are indeed the **manifest canker** and **ruin** of those who associate with them .

επει ουτοι εστι γε φανερα λωβη τε και διαφθορα των συγγιγνομενων .

Soc: What do you mean , O Anytos ? Do **they** alone of **All** those who profess to **know** how to perform

Πως λεγεις , ω Ανυτε ; αρα ουτοι μονοι των αντιποιουμενων **επιστασθαι** ευεργετειν
something well , differ so much from the others , that **they** not only **do not** render **useful** , whatsoever

τι διαφερουσι τοσουτον οσον τω αλλων , ου μονον ουκ ωφελουσιν , ο τι αν τις
is handed over to **selves** , just as **the others** , but **they** do the very opposite by **ruining** it ? And for doing

91D παραδω αυτοις , ωσπερ οι αλλοι , αλλα και το εναντιον διαφθειρουσι ; πραττεσθαι
this **they** even expect to be paid !?! Therefore , I for one , cannot put my trust in what thou are saying .

τουτων φανεφως αξιουσι χρηματα ; ουν εγω μεν εχω ουκ πιστευσω οπως σοι :

For I **know** of one man , **Protagoras** , who acquired more money from this 'wisdom' than both

γαρ **οιδα** ενα ανδρα Πρωταγοραν κτησαμενον πλειω χρηματα απο ταυτης της σοφιας η τε
Pheidias , whose **beautiful works** are thus seen everywhere , and ten other **sculptors** .

Φειδιαν , ος καλα εργα ουτω ειργαζετο περιφανως , και δεκα αλλους των ανδριαντοποιων :

And yet what you say is remarkable , on the one hand , if **those** who repair old shoes

καιτοι λεγεις τερας , μεν ει οι εργαζομενοι τα παλαια τα υποδηματα
and clothes , were to return the shoes and clothes **they** were supposed to repair in a **worse condition** than

και ιματια αποδιδοντες τα υποδηματα τε και ιματια εξακουμενοι μοχθηροτερα η
when they received them , and could then go unnoticed for thirty days . Whereas if **they** did such things ,

91E παρελαβον , αν ουκ δυναιντο λαθειν τριακονθ' ημερας , αλλ' ει ποιοιεν τοιαυτα ,
then **they** would quickly starve to death . But then the whole of Hellas **failed to notice** that **Protagoras** ,

αν ταχυ τω λιμω αποθανοιεν , δε αρα την ολην Ελλαδα ελανθε Πρωταγορας
ruined those who were his **associates** and sent them back **worse** than **he** received them for more than

διαφθειρων τους συγγιγνομενους και αποπεμπων μοχθηροτερους η παρελαμβανε πλεον η
forty years ! For I think **he** died when **he** was near seventy ; and forty of those years ,

τετταρακοντα ετη : γαρ οιμαι αυτον αποθανειν εγγυς εβδομηκοντα , και τετταρακοντα ετη
were spent in his art , and in all this time , even into this day , he has not ceased in keeping up

οντα γεγονοτα εν τη τεχνη : και εν απαντι τω χρονω ετι εις τουτω την ημεραν ουδεν πεπαυται
his **good reputation** . And not only **Protagoras** , but also a whole host of others , those who lived

ταυτηνι ευδοκιμων : και ου μονον Προταγορας , αλλα και παμπολλοι αλλοι , οι γεγονοτες
before him , and **others** still living at the present time . Furthermore , are we to say that according to thine

92A προτερον εκεινου , και δε οι ετι οντες νυν . δη ουν ποτερον φωμεν κατα τον σον
Logos ; the **sophists knowingly deceive** and **mistreat** the young , or are **they unaware themselves** ?

λογον αυτους ειδοτας εξαπαταν και λωβασθαι τους νεους , η και λεληθεναι εαυτους ;

And if this is so , then we must consider **the sophists** to be **insane** , **the very ones** who profess to be
και ουτω αξιωσομεν τουτους μαινεσθαι , ενιοι ους φασι ειναι
'the wisest' of human beings ?

σοφωτατους ανθρωπων ;

Any: **They** must indeed be quite **insane** , O Socrates , but far more **insane** are the young men who

92b δεουσι γε Πολλου μαινεσθαι , ω Σωκρατες , αλλα πολυ μαλλον των νεων οι
gave their money to **them** , but even more **insane** than **them** , are those who are their relatives , those
διδοντες αργυριον τουτοις : δ' ετι μαλλον τουτων οι προσηκοντες οι
who entrusted their young ones to **the care** of **these men** , but most especially **insane** of all are the cities ,
επιτρεποντες τουτοις δε πολυ μαλιστα παντων αι πολεις ,
who allowed **them** to enter in , and did not drive **them** out , whether such an attempt is made
εωσαι αυτους εισαφικνεισθαι καο ουκ εξελανουσαι , ειτε τοιουτον επιχειρει ποιειν
by a citizen or a foreigner .

τι αστος ειτε τις ξενος

Soc: Then what **injustice** have thou **undergone** from **the sophists** , O Anytos , or why else

δε τις ηδικηκε Ποτερον σε των σοφιστων , ω Ανυτε , η τι
would you be so hard to **them** ?

ει ουτως χαλεπος αυτοις ;

Any: No by **Zeus** , I have never **associated** with any of **them** , nor would I allow anyone else

Ουδε μα Δια εγωγε ποποτε συγγεγονα ουδενι αυτων , ουδ' αν εασαιμι ουδενα αλλον
of my own family . (των εμων .)

Soc: Then you have **absolutely no experience** of **these people** ?

αρ' ει πανταπασι Απειρος των ανδρων ;

Any: And may it remain so indeed .

92C Και ειην γε .

Soc: Then , O Blessed One , how can you **know** about **This Reality** , whether **It** has anything **Good**

ουν , ω δαιμονιε , Πως αν ειδειης περι τουτου του πραγματος , ειτε εχει τι αγαθον
in **Itself** , or whether **It** is worthless , of which you have **absolutely no experience** ?

εν εαυτω ειτε φλαυρον , ου ειης πανταπασιν απειρος ;

Any: Easily , since I do indeed **know** who **these people** are , whether I have **experience** of **them** or not .

Ραδιως : γουν οιδα οι τουτους εισιν , ειτ' ουν ειμι απειρος αυτων ειτε μη .

Soc: Perhaps you are a Seer , O Anytos , since in what other way could you **know** about **them** , for from

ισως ει Μαντις , ω Ανυτε , επει οπως αλλως γε οισθα περι τουτων , εξ
that which you yourself say about **them** , I am left to wonder . However , let us *not* try to find out who

92D ων αυτος λεγεις αν θαυμαζοιμ' . αλλα γαρ ου επιζητουμεν τινες
those are , to whom Meno can go to become worthless ; for on the one hand , let them be **the sophists** ,

τουτους εισι , παρ' ους Μενων αν αφικομενος γενοιτο μοχθηρος : γαρ μεν εστων ουτοι οι σοφισται ,
if you wish , but then on the other hand , do a good deed , and tell us who those others are , for the

ει συ βουλει , δη αλλα ευεργετησον και ειπε ημιν εκεινους

sake of your paternal companion , Meno here , by telling him self , to whom he can go in this

τον πατρικον εταιρον τονδε , φρασας αυτω , παρα τινας αφικομενος εν τοσαυτη
city in order that he can become **Worthy** of **The Logos** of **Virtue/Excellence** which I just now explained .

πολει αν γενοιτ' αξιος την λογου αρετην ην εγω νυνδη διηλθον .

Any: But why did you not tell him self ?

δε Τι συ ου εφρασας αυτω ;

Soc: But on the one hand , I did say who I thought to be **the teachers** of these , but on the other hand ,

Αλλ' μεν εγω ειπον ους ωμην ειναι διδασκαλους τουτων , αλλα

as thou say , I happen to be speaking nonsense . And perhaps , what you say is **Right** . So then ,

92E ως συ φης , τυγχανω λεγων ουδεν : και ισως τι λεγεις . αλλα δη

do thou share and tell him self to which Athenians he must go . Tell him any name you wish .

εν συ τω μερει ειπε αυτω παρα τινας Αθηναιων ελθη : ειπε οτου ονομα βουλει .

Any: But why must I be confined to one particular name ? For any of the Noble and Good Citizens

δε Τι δει ακουσαι ενος ανθρωπον ονομα ; γαρ οτω των καλων καγαθων
of Athens that he may encounter , without exception , will make him better than **the sophists** , if indeed
Αθηναιων αν εντυχη , ουδεις ος ου ποιησει αυτον βελτιω η οι σοφισται , εανπερ
he is willing to be persuaded .

εστιν εθελη πεισθεσθαι

Soc: But did these **Noble** and **Good** people come to be **This Way Spontaneously** , by having **Learned**

δε Ποτερον ουτοι οι καλοι καγαθοι εγενετο τοιουτοι απο του αυτοματου , μαθοντες
from **no** one , but are nevertheless able to teach others , that which they themselves did **not Learn** ?

93A παρ' ουδενος , μεντοι οντες ομως οι οι διδασκειν αλλους , ταυτα α αυτοι τε ουκ εμαθον ;

Any: I do indeed suspect that these people learned from the previous generation , by being also

εγωγε αξιω τουτους μαθειν παρα των προτερων , οντων Και
Noble and **Good** . Or does it not appear to thee that there have been many **Good** people in this city ?

καλων καγαθων : η ου δοκουσι σοι γεγονεναι πολλοι και αγαθοι ανδρες εν τηδε τη πολει ;

Soc: It does indeed also appear to me , O Anytos , that there are **Good statesmen** here , and there are even

Εμοιγε και δοκουσαν , ω Ανυτε , ειναι αγαθοι τα πολιτικα ενθαδε , και ειναι ετι
no less than those that came before . But have they also been **Good teachers** of **The Virtue** of selves ?

ουχ ηττον η γεγονεναι : αλλα μων και γεγωνασι αγαθοι διδασκαλοι της αυτων αρετης ;

For this is that which **The Logos** happens to be about . **Not** if there are **Good people** here or not ,

γαρ τουτο εστι ου ημιν ο λογος τυγχανει ων περι : ουκ ει εισιν αγαθοι ανδρες ενθαδε η μη ,
nor if there have been in the past , but we have been considering all along if **Excellence** is **Teachable** .

93B ουδ' ει γεγωνασιν εν τω προσθεν , αλλ' σκοπουμεν παλαι ει αρετη εστιν διδακτον .

Thus , by considering this issue , we are considering whether **Good people** , both those now and before ,

δε σκοπουντες τουτο τοδε σκοπουμεν αρα οι αγαθοι ανδρες και των νυν και των προτερων
also **knew how to Transmit** to another this **Excellence** which **The Good Selves** were , or is **This**

και ηπισταντο παραδουναι αλλω ταυτην την αρετην ην αγαθοι αυτοι ησαν , η τουτο
un-transmittable nor **receivable from one human to another** . This is the question which Meno and
ου παραδοτον ουδε παραληπτον αλλω παρ'αλλου . τουτ' εστιν ο Μενων τε και
I have all along been searching after . Therefore , consider it in this way from **The Logos** of **Thyself** ;

εγω παλαι ζητουμεν . ουν σκοπει ωδε εκ του λογου σαυτου
would thou not say that **Themistocles** was a **Good man** ?

93C αν ουκ φαιης Θεμιστολκεα γεγονεναι αγαθον ανδρα ;

Any: I would indeed ; most **Exceptional** of **All** indeed .

Εγωγε , μαλιστα παντων γε .

Soc: Is it not so then that he would also be a **Good teacher** , seeing that if anyone was a **teacher**

Ουκουν και αγαθον διδασκαλον , ειπερ τις αλλος ην διδασκαλος
The Excellence of **Self** , then that man would be one ?

της αρετης αυτου , εκεινον ειναι ;

Any: I do indeed think so , if indeed he really wanted to be one .

εγωγε Οιμαι , ειπερ γε εβουλετο .

Soc: But do you think that he would not have wanted for other people to become **Noble** and **Good** ,

Αλλ' , οiei , αν ουκ εβουληθη τε αλλους τινας γενεσθαι καλους καγαθους ,
but most especially the son of self ? Or do you think that he bore ill-will towards self and deliberately
δε που μαλιστα τον υιον τον αυτου ; η οiei αυτον φθονειν αυτω και εξεπιτηδες

did not **transmit The Excellence** of which self was **Good** ? Or have you not heard that Themistocles had **93D** ου παραδιδοναι την αρετην , ην αυτος ην αγαθος ; η ουκ ακηκοας , οτι Θεμιστοκλεις his son Kleophantos **taught** to be a **Good** horseman ? Then indeed he used to stand upright upon a pair of τον υιον Κλεοφαντον εδιδαξατο μεν αγαθον ιππεα ; γουν επεμενε εστηκως ορθος επι των horses , and hurl javelins while standing upright upon the horses , and he accomplished many other ιππων , και ηκοντιζεν απο ορθος των ιππων , και ειργαζετο πολλα αλλα amazing feats as well, in which that man had self **educated** and in which he was made **Wise**, all of which θαυμαστα και , α εκεινος αυτον επαιδευσατο και εποιοησε σοφον , οσα require **Good teachers** . Or have you not heard these things from your elders ?

ειχετο αγαθων διδασκαλων : η ουκ ακηκοας ταυτα των πρεσβυτερων ;

Any: I have heard . (Ακηκοα .)

Soc: Thus no one could lay blame by saying there was any **defect** in **The Natural Ability** of his son .

93E αρα Ουκ τις αν ητιασατ' γε ειναι κακην την φυσιν του αυτου υιου .

Any: That is not likely . (αν ουκ Ισως.)

Soc: What follows then ? Did you ever hear either from the young or the elders , that Kleophantos , Τι τοδε δε ; ηδη του ακηκοας η νεωτερου η πρεσβυτερω , ως Κλεοφαντος the son of Themistocles , had become a **Good** and **Wise** man **just as** his father ?

ο Θεμιστοκλεους εγενετο αγαθος και σοφος ανηρ απερ αυτου ο πατηρ ;

Any: Not at all . (Ου δητα .)

Soc: Take notice then , are we to believe that on the one hand , he wished to **educate** his son

Αρ' ουν οιομεθα μεν βουλεσθαι παιδευσαι αυτου τον υιον in these matters , but on the other hand , when it came to **The Wisdom** in which he himself was **Wise** , ταυτα δε ην σοφιαν ην αυτος ην σοφος , he was made no better than his neighbors , if indeed of course , **Excellence** were **teachable** ?

ποιησαι ουδεν βελτιω των γειτονων , ειπερ γε η αρετη ην διδακτον ;

Any: By **Zeus** , that is not likely !

μα Δι' ου Ισως .

Soc: Surely then on the one hand , of the previous generations , this very man was among those who

94A δη μεν των προτερων τοιουτος Ουτος ον εν τοις were **the best teachers** of **Virtue** , as thou thinest agrees . But on the other hand , we must consider ειναι αριστον διδασκαλος αρετης , και συ σοι ομολογεις : δε δη σκεψωμεθα another one , **Aristeides** , the son of Lysimachos . Or do you not agree that he was **Good** ?

αλλον , Αριστειδην τον Λυσιμαχου : η ουχ ομολογεις τουτον γεγονεναι αγαθον ;

Any: I do indeed , in every way without a doubt .

Εγωγε , παντως δηπου .

Soc: Is it not so then , that he also provided his son Lysimachos with an **education** , by **the very best**

Ουκουν ουτος και τον αυτου τον υιον Λυσιμαχον επαιδευσεν καλλιστα Athenian **teachers** , in those subjects that they maintain , whereas on the other hand , does he appear Αθηναιων διδασκαλων , οσα ειχετο , δε δοκει to thee , to have been made a **better** man than anyone ? For surely you have also been in the company of

σοι πεποιηκεναι βελτιω ανδρα οτουουν ; γαρ που και συγγεγονας this man and see what kind of man he is . Then if you wish , consider **Pericles** , such a **magnificently** **94B** τουτω και ορας οιος εστιν . δε ει βουλει Περικλεα ουτω μεγαλοπρεπως **Wise** man ; you **know** that he raised two sons , Paralos and Xanthippos .

σοφον ανδρα , οισθ' οτι εθρεψε δυο υιεις , Παραλον και Ξανθιππον ;

Any: I do indeed . (Εγωγε.)

Soc: Then on the one hand , you also **know** that these two were **taught** to be inferior to no Athenian μεντοι μεν , συ και οισθα ως Τουτους εδιδαξεν χειρους ουδενος Αθηναιων ,

in **horsemanship** , and they were also **educated** in **Music** and **wrestling** and **all** the other subjects , that
 ιππεας , και επαιδευσεν και μουσικην και αγωνιαν και ταλλα , οσα
 are kept by **Art** , to be inferior to none . Thus on the other hand , did he **not** wish to make them **Good**
 εχεται τεχνης , χειρους ουδενος : δε ουκ εβουλετο ποιησαι αγαθους
 men in **This Way** ? It appears to me on the one hand , that **he did** wish so , whereas on the other hand ,
 ανδρας αρα ; δοκω μεν , εβουλετο , αλλα
Virtue is **not teachable** . But in order that you do not think that this just happens to a few of the most
94C μη η ουκ διδακτον . δε ινα μη οη και ολιγους τους
 lowly born Athenians who are unable to accomplish **this business** , take this to heart ; that **Thucydides**
 φαυλοτατους γεγονεναι Αθηναιων αδυνατος το τουτο πραγμα , ενθυμηθητι οτι Θουκυδιδης
 also raised two sons , Melisias and Stephanos ; and they were **Well-educated** in all other ways , and
 αυ εθρεψε δυο υιεις , Μελησιαν και Στεφανον , και τουτους ευ επαιδευσε τε τα αλλα και
 they were **the best wrestlers** of the Athenians ; for one of them was **taught** by **Xanthias** , and the other
 καλλιστα επαλαισαν Αθηναιων : γαρ μεν τον εδωκε Ξανθια , δε τον
 by **Eudoros** ; and they were well reputed to be the **best wrestlers** of that time , or do you not remember ?
 Ευδωρω : δε ουτοι που εδοκουν των καλλιστα παλαιειν τοτε : η ου μεμνησαι ;
Any: I have indeed heard of them . (Εγωγε ακοη .)
Soc: Is it not clear then , on the one hand , that Thucydides would not ever , have felt the need to **teach**
 Ουκουν δηλον μεν οτι ουτος αν ουκ ποτε , εδει εδιδαξε
 his boys those subjects which cost money to **teach** , while on the other hand , he would not have then
94D τους αυτου τους παιδας ταυτα ου δαπανωμενον διδασκειν , δε ουκ δε
 felt the need to **teach** them those subjects which cost nothing to make them **Good men** , if **It** was indeed
 εδει εδιδαξεν ταυτα ου αναλωσαντα ουδεν ποιησαι αγαθους ανδρας , ει ην
teachable ?? For perhaps then , Thucydides was of lowly descent , and self did not have many friends
 διδακτον ; γαρ ισως αλλα ο Θουκυδιδης ην φαυλος , και αυτω ουκ ησαν πλειστοι φιλοι
 among the Athenians and among her allies ? And yet , he was descended from a great family and he had
 Αθηναιων και των συμμαχων ; και ην μεγαλης οικιας και
 great influence in the city and among the other Hellenes , so that , if indeed **Excellence** were **teachable** ,
 μεγα εδυνατο εν τη πολει και εν τοις αλλοις Ελλησιν , ωστε ειπερ τουτο ην διδακτον ,
 and if self did not have any leisure time , because of his **Attentive-care** of the city , then surely he would
 ει αυτος μη εσχολαζε δια την επιμελειαν της ποεως αν
 have found someone else who would be able to make his sons **Good** , whether they were some native
 εξευρειν οστις εμελλεν ποιησειν αυτου τους υιεις αγαθους , η των τις επιχωριων
 or foreigner . But I am afraid , O companion Anytos , that **Excellence/Virtue** is **not teachable** .
 η των ξενων . αλλα γαρ μη , ω εταιρε Ανυτε , αρετη η ουκ διδακτον .
Any: O Socrates, you appear to me to easily speak badly about human beings . Therefore on the one
 Ω Σωκρατες , δοκεις μοι ραδιως λεγειν κακως ανθρωπους . ουν μεν
 hand , I will give thee some advice , if you will be persuaded by me . Be careful . Since perhaps , it may
 εγω αν σοι συμβουλευσαιμι , ει εθελεις πειθεσθαι εμοι , ευλαβεισθαι : ως ισως και μεν
 be easy to do harm or benefit to people in other cities , in this city it is very easy . But on the other hand ,
 εστι ραον ποιειν κακως η ευ ανθρωπους εν αλλη πολει , εν τηδε και δε πανυ : δε
 I think that even thy self **know** this . (**Exit Anytos**)
95A οιμαι και σε αυτον ειδεναι .
Soc: O Meno , it appears to me that Anytos is angry ; but it does not at all surprise me , for first of all ,
 Ω Μενων , δοκει μοι μεν Ανυτος χαλεπαινειν : δε ουδεν θαυμαζω : γαρ πρωτον
 he thinks that I am accusing **These men** , and secondly he lets himself believe that self is one of **These** .
 μεν οιεται με κακηγορειν τουτους τους ανδρας , επειτα και ηγεται αυτος ειναι εις τουτων .

παρ' υμιν ;

Πανυ γε .

95B Τί οὖν ; οὗτοι ἐθέλουσιν παρεχειν αὐτοὺς διδασκαλοὺς τοῖς νεοῖς , καὶ ὁμολογεῖν
that **Virtue** is **teachable** and that they are **Its teachers** ?

Ου μα τον Δία , ὦ Σωκράτης , ἀλλὰ τότε μὲν ἀν ἀκουσας αὐτῶν ὡς διδάκτον ,
but at other times you will hear that **It is *not*** .

ουν Φωμεν τουτους ειναι διδασκαλους τουτου του πραγματος ,
concerning which , they do not even agree on this point about **Self** ?

Τι δε ; δη δοκουσι σοι οι σοφιστοι ειναι διδασκαλοι αρετης , ουτοι οιπερ
alone profess to be so ?

Και ταυτα μάλιστα αγαμαι Γοργίου , ω Σωκρατες, οτι αν ουκ ποτε
hear him professing/proclaiming/promising this ; instead he laughs at all the other **sophists** , when
ακουσαις αυτου υπισχνουμενου τουτο , αλλα και καταγελα των αλλων , οταν
he hears them proclaiming this . Whereas he thinks that **they** must make clever speakers .

Ουκ εχω λεγειν , ω Σωκράτης , γαρ ⁵³αυτος πεπονηθα και οπερ οι πολλοι :
So that **at one time** they appear to me to be **teachers** , but **at other times** , **they do not** .

95D δε Οισθα οτι ου μονον τουτο δοκει σοι τε και τοις αλλοις πολιτικοις ειναι διδακτον
at one time , but *at another time not* , but it also appears in this way to **Theognis** the poet , for you know

τοτε μεν , τοτε δ' ου , αλλα και Θεογονιν τον ποιητον ιοισθ' ,
that he says *the very same thing* ?

Εν τοις ἐλεγείοις , οὐ λέγει – καὶ παρὰ τοῖσιν πίνε καὶ ἐσθίε , καὶ μετὰ τοῖσιν ἰζε ,

and gratify those , who have great power . For on the one hand from the noble, the noble are taught .
και ανδανε τοις , ων μεγαλη δυναμις . γαρ μεν απ’ εσθλα εσθλων διδαζεαι :
But on the other hand , whoever mixes with the bad , loses even what mind they may have .”

95E δε ην συμμισης κακοισιν απολεις και τον νοον εοντα .
You **know** that in these verses he speaks , on the one hand , as if **Excellence** is **teachable** ?

οισθ’ οτι εν τουτοις λεγει μεν ως της αρετης ουσης διδακτου ;

Men: It is manifest indeed . (Φαινεται γε .)

Soc: Whereas on the other hand , in some other verses just a few lines on he says : “If it were possible

δε Εν αλλοις γε ολιγον μεταβας φησι , ει ην
to make , then **Intelligence** could also be **Implanted** in man” . He says that somehow “Those who have
ποιητον νοημα και ενθετον ανδρι , λεγει οτι πως οι
the power to do This , would carry away many and large fees” , and that “Never would a **bad child**
δυναμενοι ποιειν τουτο αν εφερον πολλους και μεγαλους μισθους , και ου ποτ’αν κακος
be born of a **Good father** , for **they** would be persuaded by **sound** words . But you will never make a
96A εγενετο εξ αγαθου πατρος , πειθομενος σαοφροσιν μυθοισι . αλλα ου ποτε ποιησεις τον
bad man Good by **teaching** .” Do you see that when he speaks about the same things again , that he
κακον ανδρ αγαθον διδασκων . εννοεις οτι λεγει περι των αυτων παλιν αυτος
contradicts him self ?

ταναντια αυτω ;

Men: It is manifest . (Φαινεται .)

Soc: Therefore , on the one hand , can you say there is any business at all , in which **those** who proclaim

ουν μεν Εχεις ειπειν αλλου πραγματος οτουουν , ου οι φασκοντες
to be **teachers** , are not generally agreed to be **teachers** of others , nor even to have any knowledge
διδασκαλοι ειναι ουχ οπως ομολογουνται διδασκαλοι αλλων , ουδε αλλ’ επιστασθαι
of their subject , but to be **worthless** concerning this very business of which **they** claim to be **teachers** .

96B αυτοι , αλλα ειναι πονηροι περι τουτο αυτο το πραγμα ου φασι ειναι διδασκαλοι ,
But then on the other hand , **those** who proclaim to be **Noble** and **Good selves** all concur ,

δε οι φασιν ειναι καλοι καγαθοι αυτοι ομολογουμενοι
that it is **teachable at times** , but **at other times not** ? Therefore , of **those** who are so confused about
αυτο διδακτον τοτε μεν , τοτε δε ου ; ουν τους ουτω τεταραγμενους περι
any subject at all , would you say that **they** are **Genuine teachers** ?

οτουουν αν συ φαιης ειναι κυριως διδασκαλους ;

Men: By **Zeus** , not I indeed ! (Μα Δι’ ουκ εγωγε .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that if neither **the sophists** nor **those** who are **Noble** and **Good selves** ,

Ουκουν ει μητε οι σοφισται μητε οι καλοι καγαθοι αυτοι
are the **teachers** of **This Reality** , then it is indeed clear that **no one** else could ?

οντες διδασκαλοι του πραγματος , εισι γε δηλον οτι ουκ αλλοι αν ;

Men: It does not appear so to me . (Ου δοκει μοι .)

Soc: But if indeed there are **no teachers** , then there are **no learners** ?

96C Ει γε μη διδασκαλοι , δε ουδε μαθητα ;

Men: It appears to me that it has to be as you say .

Δοκει μοι εχειν ως λεγεις .

Soc: But we have indeed agreed , that if there is a **Reality** for which there are neither **teachers**

δε γε Ωμολογηκαμεν εινεν πραγματος ου μητε διδασκαλοι
nor **learners** , then **This** is **not teachable** ?

μητε μαθηται , τουτο ειναι μηδε διδακτον ;

Men: We have agreed .

Ωμολογηκαμεν .

Soc: Has it not then come to **Light** that there are **no teachers** of **Virtue anywhere** ?

Ουκουν φαινονται διδασκαλοι αρετης ουδαμου ;

Men: This is so . (ταυτα Εστι .)

Soc: And if there are indeed **no teachers** , then there are **no learners** ?

Ει γε μη διδασκαλοι , δε ουδε μαθηται ;

Men: It has come to **Light** in this way . (Φαινεται ουτως .)

Soc: Accordingly then , **Excellence/Virtue** cannot be **teachable** ?

αρα Αρετη αν ουκ ειη διδακτον ;

Meno: It is not likely ; if indeed **It** has been considered **Rightly** by us .

96D Ουκ εοικεν , επερ εσκεμμεθα ορθως ημεις .

So that I am also thus **Wondering** , O Socrates , whether **Good people** do not exist at all ,

ωστε και δη θαυμαζω , ω Σωκρατες , ποτερον αγαθοι ανδρες ουδ' εισιν ποτε ,

or what is **The Way of Generation** by which **Those** that are **Good** come to be .

η τις της τροπος γενεσεως αν των ειη αγαθων γιγνομενων .

Soc: I am afraid , O Meno , that thou and I are some worthless men , since thou has **not** been **educated**

Κινδυνευομεν , ω Μενων , τε συ και εγω ειναι τινες φαυλοι ανδρες , και σε ουχ πεπαιδευκεναι sufficiently by **Gorgias** nor I by **Prodicos** . Therefore , most of all , we must **Offer-up our Mind**

ικανως Γοργιας και εμε Προδικος . ουν μαλλον παντος προσεκτεον ημιν τον νουν to these concerns , and we must search for whoever has even **One Way** that will make us **Better** . But

αυτοις , και ζητεον οστις γε ενι τροπω ποιησει ημας βελτιους : δε I say this while looking at our recent enquiry ; since it is ridiculous that we failed to notice , that it is

96E λεγω ταυτα αποβλεψας προς την αρτι ζητησιν , ως καταγελαστως ημας ελαθε , οτι **not only** when **Knowledge Guides Rightly** , that human affairs are done **Successfully** , and perhaps

ου μονον επιστημης ηγουμενης ορθως τοις ανθρωποις τα πραγματα πραττεται ευ , και ισως that is also why , **The Realization** escaped us , *In What Way Good people* ever come to be .

και τε και η το γνωναι διαφευγει ημας , τινα τροπον οι αγαθοι ανδρες ποτε γινονται .

Men: How do you mean this , O Socrates ?

Πως λεγεις τουτο , ω Σωκρατες ;

Soc: In the following **Way** . On the one hand , it is **Necessary** that **Good people Be Beneficial/Useful** ,

Ωδε : μεν δει οτι αγαθους ανδρας ειναι ωφελιμους , and we indeed agreed **Rightly** (88D) , that this **Could not Be otherwise** . Do you agree ?

97A γε ωμολογηκαμεν ορθως , οτι τουτο αν ουκ εχοι αλλως : η γαρ ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And that **they** will indeed be **Beneficial** , if they **Guide** our affairs **Rightly** ,

Και οτι γε εσονται ωφελιμοι , αν ηγωνται ημιν των πραγματων ορθως , and this of course we agreed **Correctly** ?

και τουτο που ωμολογουμεν καλως ;

Men: Yes .(Ναι .)

Soc: But on the other hand , that that it is **not Possible** to **Guide Correctly** , if one is **not Mindful** .

δ' Οτι εστιν ουκ ηγεισθαι ορθως , εαν η μη φρονιμος , It is likely that we did **not Rightly** agree to this .

ομοιοι εσμεν ουκ ορθως ωμολογηκοσιν τουτο .

Men: In what way then , do you mean ?

πως δη λεγεις ;

Soc: I will tell you . If **someone Knows The Road** to **Larissa (The Citadel)** , or wherever else you wish ,

Εγω ερω . ει τις **ειδως** την οδον εις την Λαρισαν η οποι αλλοσε βουλει by **Traveling** and by **Guiding** others there , would **they Guide** in any other way than **Well** and **Rightly** ?

βαδιζοι και ηγοιτο αλλοις , αν ηγοιτο τι αλλο ευ και ορθως ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: But what if on the one hand , **someone Opines Correctly** , that which is **The Road** , whereas on the other hand , **they** have never been there , nor do **they really know** ; would **they** not also **Guide Rightly** ?
μη εληλυθως μηδ' επισταμενος , αν ουτος ου και ηγοιτο ορθως ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: And as long as **they** may indeed somehow have the **Right Opinion** concerning **That** which **the other** has **Knowledge** , they will be **no worse** a **Guide** , but **the one guesses The Truth** , and is **not Mindful** ,
επιστημην , εσται ουδεν χειρων ηγεμων , μεν οιομενος αληθη , δε μη φρονων ,
while **the other** is **Mindful** .
του τουτο φρονουντος .

Men: For the one is **no worse** a **Guide** .

γαρ Ουδεν .

Soc: Accordingly then , in regards to **Correctness** of **Action** , **True Opinion** is **no worse** of a **Guide** **α**ρα **π**ρος ορθοτητα πραξεως αληθης Δοξα ουδεν χειρων ηγεμων than **Mindfulness** . And while considering **what The Nature** of **Virtue** is , we **were** saying that **only** **97C** φρονησεως : και εν τη σκεπει τι της οποιον περι αρετης εστιν λεγοντες οτι μονον **Mindfulness Guides** human affairs **Rightly** . But **we were neglecting** this which we just now **See** .
φρονησις ηγεται του πραττειν ορθως δε ειη παρελειπομεν τουτο ο νυνδη :
That accordingly , **True Opinion** also **Guides Rightly** .

το αρα αληθης δοξα και ην .

Men: This is indeed likely . (Εοικε γε .)

Soc: Accordingly then , **Right Opinion** is **no less Useful/Beneficial** than **Knowledge** .

αρα ορθη δοξα εστιν Ουδεν ηττον ωφελιμον επιστημης .

Men: In such a way indeed , O Socrates , that the one who has Knowledge would always hit the mark ,
Τοσουτω γε , ω Σωκρατες , οτι ο μεν εχων την επιστημην αν αιει επιτυγχανει ,
while the one who has right opinion would hit the mark at times , but at other times , not .

ο δε την ορθην δοξαν αν τυγχανει τοτε μεν , τοτε δ' ου .

Soc: What do you mean ? Will not the one who **Always** has **Right Opinion** , **Always Hit The Mark** ,

Πως λεγεις ; ουκ ο αιει εχων ορθην δοξαν αιει τυγχανει ,
for as long as they **Opine Correctly** ?

εωσπερ δοξαζοι ορθα ;

Men: It is manifest to me that it is necessary ; so that I wonder why , O Socrates , this has to be

97D φαινεται μοι Αναγκη : ωστε θαυμαζω ποτε , ω Σωκρατες , τουτου εχοντος
in this way , since **Knowledge** is surely much **More-honored** than **Right Opinion** , and what accounts for
ουτως , οτι η επιστημη δη πολυ τιμωτερα της ορθης δοξης , και ο τι δι' εστιν
the difference between selves ?

το μεν ετερον , το δε ετερον αυτων .

Soc: Then do you **know** what accounts for your state of wonder , or shall I tell thee ?

ουν Οισθα οτι δι' θαυμαζεις , η εγω ειπω σοι ;

Men: Please tell me . (Πανυ γ' ειπε .)

Soc: Because you have **not Offered-up your Mind** to **The Divine Images** of **Daedalos** .

Οτι ου προσεσχηκας τον νουν τοις αγαλμασιν Δαιδαλου :
but perhaps there are none where you live .

δε ισως εστι ουδ' παρ' υμιν .

Men: To what then does this refer ?

Προς τι δε τουτο λεγεις ;

Soc: That on the one hand , **They** will also **run-away** and **escape** , if **They** have **not been bound** ,

Οτι μεν ταυτα και , αποδιδρασκει και δραπετειει , εαν η μη δεδεμενα ,
whereas on the other hand , if **They have been bound** then **They Remain** .

δε εαν δεδεμενα παραμενει .

Men: What follows from that then ?

Τι δη ουν ;

Soc: That any **Work** of **Art** of Daedalos that is **left loose** is not worth much to acquire , on the one hand ,

97E Οτι τινος των ποιηματων εκεινου λελυμενον εστι ου αξιον πολλης εκτησθαι , μεν
for it is **just like** acquiring a **run-away slave** , for **They** do **not Remain** ; but on the other hand , **They are**

ωσπερ δραπετην ανθρωπον : γαρ ου παραμενει : δε

worth much if They have been bound , for his **Works** are **Very Beautiful** . To what then am I referring

αξιον πολλου δεδεμενον ; γαρ τα εργα εστι πανυ καλα . προς τι ουν λεγω

by saying this ? To **True Opinions** .

For **True Opinions** are also **Beautiful Possessions** , and **All**

δη ταυτα ; προς τας αληθεις τας δοξας . γαρ αι αληθεις αι δοξαι και καλον το χρημα και παντα

they effect/do/work is **Good** , on the one hand , **for as long a time** as **they** may **Remain** , on the other

98A εργαζονται ταγαθα : μεν οσον χρονον αν παραμενωσι , δε

hand , **they** are **not willing** to **Remain for a long time** , and so , **they run-away** from **the soul** of humans ,

ουκ εθελουσι παραμενειν πολυν χρονον , αλλα δραπετεουσιν εκ της ψυχης του ανθρωπου ,

so that **they** are **not worth much** , **until they** are **bound** by a **Certain Reasoning** into **Causes (Phaedo 99A)** .

ωστε εισιν ου αξιαι πολλου , εως αυτας αν δηση τις λογισμω αιτιας .

But **This** , my companion Meno , is **Recollection** , as it was previously agreed by us . Thus , in the first

δ' τουτο , εταιρε Μενων , εστιν αναμνησις , ως εν τοις προσθεν ωμολογηται ημιν . δε πρωτον

place , after **they have been bound** , **they** become **Knowledge** , and **at that time They Steadfastly Abide** .

μεν επειδαν δεθωσι , γιγονται επιστημαι , επειτα μονιμοι :

And surely then because of this **Knowledge** is **More-Honored** than **Right Opinion** , and **Knowledge**

και δη δια ταυτα επιστημη εστι τιμιωτερον ορθης δοξης , και επιστημη

Differs from **Right Opinion** by **being bound** .

διαφερει ορθης δοξης δεσμω .

Men: By **Zeus** , O Socrates , it is likely to be in such a way .

Νη τον Δια , ω Σωκρατες , εοικε τοιoutw τινι .

Soc: And I certainly do not speak as one who **Knows** , but by **Way** of **Comparison** . However , that there

98B Και εγω και μην ουκ λεγω ως ειδως , αλλ' εικαζων : δε οτι

is a **Difference** between **Right Opinion** and **Knowledge** , as it appears to me , I do not at all infer **This** ,

εστι τι αλλοιον ορθη δοξα και επιστημη , δοκω μοι ου πανυ τουτο

by **Comparison** , but if indeed there is anything that I would say I **Know** , since there are very few things

εικαζειν , αλλ' ειπερ τι αλλο αν φαιην ειδεναι , δ' ολιγα

I would say this about , **This One** then , I will also include among **Those** which I **Know** .

αν φαιην , τουτο δ' ουν αν και θειην εν εκεινων ων οйда .

Men: And you speak correctly indeed , O Socrates .

Και λεγεις ορθως γε , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: What then ? Is the following not correct , that when **True Opinion Guides** , **It is in no way inferior**

Τι δε ; τοδε ουκ ορθως , οτι αληθης δοξα ηγουμενη ουδεν χειρον

than **Knowledge** in **bringing to Completion** The Aim/Business/Function of each and every **Work/Deed** .

η επιστημη απεργαζεται της πραξεως το εκαστης εργον .

Men: There again you appear to me to speak the Truth .

τουτο Και δοκεις μοι λεγειν αληθη .

Soc: Accordingly then , **Right Opinion** will be **in no way inferior nor less Beneficial** than **Knowledge**

98C αρα ορθη δοξα εστι Ουδεν χειρον ουδε ηττον ωφελιμη επιστημης

in every Aim/Business/Function , nor will the one who has **Right Opinion** rather than **Knowledge** ?
εις τας πραξεις ουδε ανηρ ο εχων ορθην δοξαν η ο επιστημην .

Men: This is so . (ταυτα Εστι .)

Soc: And it was certainly agreed by us , that a **person** who is **Good** , is indeed **Beneficial/Useful** ?

Και μην ωμολογηται ημιν ανηρ ο αγαθος ειναι γε ωφελιμος .

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Now then , seeing that it is **not only** through **Knowledge** , **but also through Right Opinion** ,
τοιουν επειδη ου μονον δι' επιστημην , αλλα και δι' ορθην δοξαν
that people can be **Good** and **Beneficial** to their cities , if indeed they can be , but that neither of **These** ;
ανδρες αν ειεν αγαθοι και ωφελιμοι ταις πολεσιν , ειπερ ειεν , δε ουδετερον τουτοι
neither **Knowledge** nor **True Opinion** , arise **Naturally** in human beings , since **They** are acquired –
ουτε επιστημη ουτε αληθης δοξα , εστι φυσει τοις ανθρωποις , οντ' επικτητα –
Or does it appear to thee that either of **These** arise **Naturally** ?

98D η δοκει σοι οποτερονουν αυτοιν ενιαι φυσει ;

Men: Not to me indeed . (Ουκ εμοιγε .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that since **They do not** arise **Naturally** , neither can people be **Naturally Good** .

Ουκουν επειδη ου φυσει , ουδε αν ειεν φυσει αγαθοι .

Men: Certainly not . (δητα Ου .)

Soc: Then seeing that **It** does not arise **Naturally** , we were then considering this , if **It** was **teachable** .

δε επειδη γε ου φυσει , εσκοπουμεν μετα τουτο , ει εστιν διδακτον .

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: Is it not so then , that we **Opined** that if **Virtue** was **Mindfulness** , then **It** was **teachable** ?

Ουκουν εδοξεν ει η αρετη φρονησις ειναι διδακτον ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: And if **It** were indeed **teachable** , then it would be **Mindfulness** ?

Καν ει ειη γε διδακτον , αν ειναι φρονησις ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: And if on the one hand , there were indeed **teachers** , then **It** might be **teachable** ;

98E Και ει μεν ειεν γε διδασκαλοι , αν ειναι διδακτον ,

whereas on the other hand , if there were **none** , then **It** would **not** be **teachable** ?

δε οντων μη ου διδακτον ;

Men: This is so . (Ουτως .)

Soc: But we certainly agreed that there were **no teachers** of **Self** ?

Αλλα μην ωμολογηκαμεν ειναι μη διδασκαλους αυτου ;

Men: This is so . (ταυτα Εστι .)

Soc: Accordingly then , we agreed that **Self** was **neither teachable nor Mindfulness** ?

αρα Ωμολογηκαμεν αυτο ειναι μητε διδακτον μητε φρονησιν ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: But we certainly agreed that **Self** was indeed **Good** ?

Αλλα μην ομολογουμεν αυτο ειναι γε αγαθον ;

Men: Yes . (Ναι .)

Soc: But **That** which is **Beneficial** and **Good** is **That** which **Guides Rightly** ?

δε Ωφελιμον και αγαθον ειναι το ηγουμενον ορθως ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: But only **These Two Beings** indeed , **True Opinion** and **Knowledge** , **Guide Rightly** ,

99A δε μονα ταυτα δυο οντα γε , αληθη δοξαν τε και επιστημην , ηγεισθαι Ορθως ,
which if possessed by a human being , then **They** will **Guide Rightly** . For **Those** that come to **Be**

α εχων ανθρωπος ηγεται ορθως . γαρ τα γινομενα

by **Providence** do **not** come to **Be** from human **Guidance** . But when a human being **Guides According**
απο τυχης ουκ γινεται ανθρωπινη ηγεμονια : δε ανθρωπος ηγεμων επι
to **That** which is **Right** , then it is according to **These Two Beings** ; **True Opinion** and **Knowledge** .
το ων ορθον , εστιν ταυτα δυο , αληθης δοξα και επιστημη .

Men: It appears to me in this way . (Δοκει μοι ουτως .)

Soc: Is it not the case then , seeing that **Virtue/Excellence** is **not teachable** ,

Ουκουν επειδη η αρετη εστιν ου διδακτον ,
then we can no longer take **Self** to be **Knowledge** ?

δη ουδ' επι γινεται επιστημη ;

Men: It does not appear to be . (Ου φαινεται .)

Soc: Accordingly then , **One** of **The Two Good** and **Useful Beings** , has been excluded .

99B αρα μεν ετερον το Δυοιν αγαθον και ωφελιμοιν οντοιν απολελυται ,
And so **Knowledge** cannot be **Guiding** in political affairs .

και επιστημη αν ουκ ειη ηγεμων εν πολιτικη πραξει .

Men: It does not appear so to me . (Ουδοκει μοι .)

Soc: Accordingly then , it was **not** by some kind of **Wisdom** nor by being **Wise** , that such people
αρα Ουκ τινι σοφια ουδε οντες σοφοι , οι τοιουτοι ανδρες
as both Themistocles and those whom Anytos was just mentioning , were **Guiding** our cities . And
αμφι Θεμιστοκλεα τε και οι ους Ανυτος αρτι οδε ελεγε : ηγουντα ταις πολεσιν , τε και
for which reason , they were not able to make others the kind of people they themselves were ,
διο ουχ οιοι ποιειν αλλους οιοι τοιουτους αυτοι εισιν ,
inasmuch as it is **not through Knowledge** that they were such as this .

ατε ου δι' επιστημην οντες τοιουτοι .
Men: It is likely that it has to be in this way , O Socrates , as you say .

Εοικεν εχειν ουτως , ω Σωκρατες , ως λεγεις .
Soc: Is it not so then , that if it is **not through Knowledge** , surely then it remains that **Self** arises through

99C Ουκουν ει μη επιστημη , δη λοιπον το γινεται
Good-Opinion . **This** is what people who are politicians/Statesmen **Use** to maintain their cities **Upright** .

ευδοξια : η ανδρες οι πολιτικοι χρωμενοι τας πολεις ορθουσιν ,
But in regards to **The Mindful** , **They** function no differently than **Oracles** or even **Divine Prophets** .

προς το φρονειν εχοντες ουδεν διαφεροντως η οι χρησμωνδοι τε και οι θεομαντεις :
For on the one hand , these also speak much that is also **True** , whereas on the other hand ,
γαρ μεν ουτοι και λεγουσι πολλα και αληθη , δε
they **know nothing** of that which they are saying .

ισασι ουδεν ων λεγουσιν .

Men: I dare say that it has to be in this way .

Κινδυνευει εχειν ουτως .
Soc: Is it not **Proper** then , O Meno , to call these people **Divine** , who **without** having **Mind/Intellect** ,
Ουκουν αξιον , ω Μενων , καλειν τους τουτους ανδρας θειους , οιτινες μη εχοντες νουν
still **Set Aright** many and grand affairs by that which they say and do ?

κατορθουσιν πολλα και μεγαλα ων λεγουσιν και πραττουσι ;

Men: Very much so . (Πανυ γε .)

Soc: Accordingly then , we would **Rightly** call **Divine** , all those of whom we were just now speaking ,

99D αρ' αν Ορθως καλοιμεν θειους , απαντας ους νυνδη ελεγομεν
the **Oracles** and **Prophets** and the **Poets** , and not least of all , the **Statesmen** ,

τους χρησμωνδους τε και μαντεις και ποιητικους , και ουχ ηκιστα τουτων τους πολιτικους
who we must declare to be **Divine** , and to be **Divinely-Inspired** , by being **Breathed-upon** and also

αν φαιμεν ειναι θειους τε και ενθουσιαζειν , οντας επιπνους και

by being **Possessed** by **The God** , when they **Set Aright** many and grand affairs through **Speech** ,
κατεχομενους εκ του θεου , οταν κατορθωσι πολλα και μεγαλα πραγματα λεγοντες ,
while **knowing nothing** of which they speak .

ειδοτες μηδεν ων λεγουσιν .

Men: Very much so .

Πανυ γε .

Soc: And without a doubt the women , O Meno , indeed call those people who are **Good** , **Divine** .

Και δηπου αι γυναικες , ω Μενων , γε καλουσι τους ανδρας αγαθους θειους :
And when the Spartans praise any **Good** person , they say "This **Divine** person ."

και οταν οι Λακωνες εγκωμιαζωσιν τινα αγαθον ανδρα , φασιν ουτος θειους ανηρ .

Men: And it is quite manifest , O Socrates , that you speak **Rightly** .

99E Και γε φαινοντι , ω Σωκρατες , λεγειν ορθως .

Even though perhaps , Anytos may be offended by this statement of thine .

καιτοι ισως Ανυτος αχθεται οδε λεγοντι σοι .

Soc: That does not concern me at all . For on the one hand , O Meno , we will converse with him again .

Ουδεν μελει εμοιγε . και μεν , ω Μενων , διαλεξομεθα τουτω αυθις :
But now on the other hand , if we were **Right** in the way in which we spoke and investigated **This**

νυν δε ει ημεις καλως εν ελεγομεν τε και εζητησαμεν τουτω

Whole Logos , then **Virtue/Excellence** would *neither* arise by **Nature** *nor* be **teachable** , since
παντι τω λογω , αρετη αν ουτε ειη φυσει ουτε ειη διδακτον , αλλα
Self Comes without **Intellect/Mind** by **Divine Dispensation** , to those to whom **Self** may come , unless
παραγινομενη ανευ νου θεια μοιρα , οις αν παραγινηται , ει μη
there is such a person among our statesmen , who can also make another person into a statesman .

100A ειη τοιουτος τις των πολιτικων ανδρων , οιος και ποιησαι αλλον πολιτικον .

But if there is , then this individual could almost be said to be so , among the living , such as Homer says

ει ειη , δε ουτος τι αν σχεδον λεγοιτο τοιουτος εν τοις ζωσιν , οιον Ομηρος εφη
that **Teiresias** was , among the dead , when he says concerning **Self** , that
τον Τειρεσιαν ειναι εν τοις τεθνεωσι , λεγων περι αυτου , οτι

*“Such a Man has **The Breath of Life/Salt/Mindfulness** among those in Hades/The Invisible Realm*

οιος πεπνυται των εν Αιδου ,
while the others are but flittering shadows .”
δε αι αισσουσι σκιαι .

And for such a man , the same relation would also exist in this realm , just as **Excellence/Virtue**

και ο τοιουτος ταυτον αν και ενθαδε , ωσπερ αρετην
would be **True Reality** as compared to shadows .

αν ειη αληθες πραγμα παρα προς σκιας .

Men: You appear to me to speak Most-Excellently/Beautifully , O Socrates .

100B δοκεις μοι λεγειν Καλλιστα , ω Σωκρατες .

Soc: Now then on the one hand , from **This Reasoning** , O Meno , it has come to **Light** for us that **Virtue**

τοιουν μεν Εκ τουτου του λογισμω , ω Μενων , φαινεται ημιν η αρετη
comes by **Divine Dispensation** to those to whom **Self** comes , whereas on the other hand , we shall have
παραγινομενη θεια μοιρα οις παραγινηται : δε εισομεθα

Clear Knowledge about **Self** , at that time when , before enquiring , in what way **Excellence** comes

σαφες το περι αυτου τοτε οταν πριν ωτινι τροπω αρετη παραγινηται
to human beings , we must first try to discover *What in the world is **Excellence/Virtue** , **Self-by-Self*** .

τοις αθθρωποις , προτερον επιχειρησωμεν ζητειν τι ποτ' εστιν αρετη αυτο καθ' αυτο .

But now on the one hand , the hour has come for me to go , but on the other hand ,
 δ' νυν μεν ωρα ποι εμοι ιεναι , δε
 thou must persuade your guest-friend Anytos , just as you are here and now persuaded by these **Words** ,
 συ πεπεισαι τον ξενον Ανυτον , απερ και τονδε πειθε ταυτα ,
 in order that self be more-gentle . For if you can persuade him , then it is a **Beneficial/Profitable/Useful**
 ινα αυτος η πραοτερος : ως εαν πεισης τουτον , εστιν τι ονησεις
Service which thou will also effect for the Athenians .
 ο και Αθηναιους .

6 Nov 2013 – 22 March 2018

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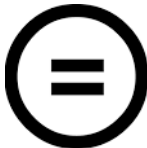
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